BASCO documentation

User guide and API reference

Formal covariance analysis of binary-asteroid masses, gravity parameters and initial states using coupled translational and rotational dynamics.

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Source revision: 05e1dad

Complete searchable reference: ashcav1.github.io/BASCO-docs/

PDF handbook

The handbook combines the guides and public API index. The complete searchable reference, including internal and legacy entries, is available on the website. You can also use the browser's Save as PDF command to export this page.

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Installation and first example

BASCO computes formal covariance for binary-asteroid masses, moments of inertia and gravity parameters. A script supplies the bodies, nominal state, mutual gravity order, estimated parameters and measurement assumptions. The library propagates the state and sensitivities, assembles measurement derivatives and computes covariance and derived reports.

The example below uses the same public components as the Hera reproduction. Its one-hour duration leaves some gravity-parameter combinations unconstrained. The reported rank and unavailable uncertainties identify those combinations.

Installation

Run these commands from the BASCO checkout, using a host Python 3.11 or newer and `uv`:

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py bootstrap
python3 -B tools/dev.py build
python3 -B tools/dev.py ad_environment
python3 -B tools/dev.py test
```

The build requires a C++ compiler, CMake, pkg-config, Armadillo and OpenBLAS development libraries. The managed helper stores its interpreter, installed wheel, native build and command logs in the machine-local BASCO cache. Scientific scripts run against that installed package outside the checkout. After editing library source, rebuild; the installed wheel does not follow source edits automatically.

The currently validated platform is macOS arm64. The native dependencies on the validated machine require macOS 26.0. A successful run on another platform remains a separate portability check.

If installing a built package instead of using the repository helper, request the recommended optional dependencies as `basco[ad,plot]`. BASCO still needs its compiled native extensions. The runtime troubleshooting guide distinguishes host, build and scientific environments.

Covariance example

Save this as `my_binary.py` in the repository. Every physical number below uses metres, kilograms, seconds and radians. `axes` are semi-axes. This is the same composition validated in the existing getting-started guide.

```python
from pathlib import Path

import numpy as np
import basco as bc

primary = bc.Body(
    "primary",
    bc.UniformEllipsoid(axes=[400.0, 350.0, 300.0], density=2200.0),
)
secondary = bc.Body(
    "secondary",
    bc.UniformEllipsoid(axes=[90.0, 75.0, 60.0], density=2200.0),
)

G = bc.G_SI
separation = 2000.0
n = np.sqrt(G * (primary.mass + secondary.mass) / separation**3)
state = bc.BinaryState(
    position=[separation, 0.0, 0.0],
    velocity=[0.0, separation * n, 0.0],
    omega_primary=[0.0, 0.0, 2.0 * np.pi / 14400.0],
    omega_secondary=[0.2 * n, 0.1 * n, n],
    A_to_N=np.eye(3),
    B_to_A=np.eye(3),
)
system = bc.BinarySystem(primary, secondary, state, G=G, name="my binary")
model = bc.BinaryDynamics(system, gravity=bc.HouGravity(mutual_order=6))

parameters = (
    bc.Parameters(model)
    .estimate_masses()
    .estimate_moments(degrees=(2,))
    .estimate_harmonics(degrees=(3, 4))
    .estimate_initial_state()
)
measurements = bc.ObservationPlan.uniform(
    stop=3600.0,
    cadence=600.0,
    channels=(
        bc.RelativePosition(sigma=1.0),
        bc.BodyAttitude("primary", sigma=np.deg2rad(1.0)),
        bc.BodyAttitude("secondary", sigma=np.deg2rad(1.0)),
        bc.PrimaryBarycentricPosition(
            sigma=1.0,
            nuisance=bc.PolynomialBias("barycenter", degree=1),
        ),
    ),
)
study = bc.CovarianceStudy(
    model,
    parameters,
    measurements,
    integrator=bc.RK4(dt=60.0),
    priors=(),
    solver=bc.SquareRootSolver(),
)

print(study.describe()["unknown_labels"])
rows = study.linearize()
result = rows.covariance()
print(result.summary())
print(result.mass_properties().summary())

folder = bc.export_study(
    rows,
```

```
    result,
    root=Path(__file__).resolve().parent / "results",
    label="my-binary-g06-e04",
)
print(folder)
```

Run it with:

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py run my_binary.py
```

This chooses Hou automatic differentiation. JAX is optional at installation/import time, but required when this default provider propagates. Missing JAX produces an actionable error; BASCO never silently chooses a different derivative method.

The launcher starts outside the repository. Script-relative paths should use `Path(__file__)`, as the example does. The returned export path points to tables, diagnostics, named arrays and a checksum manifest. See reading results before interpreting uncertainty numbers.

Native analytic derivatives

Add this keyword to the study constructor:

```
transport=bc.NativeAnalyticTransport(),
```

Then run:

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --native my_binary.py
```

Both choices matter: the constructor chooses the scientific provider, while `--native` chooses an environment without JAX. The native route preserves the hand-derived Hou partials and the same physical model and parameter map. Derivative methods explains what is shared and what is independently checked.

Figure export

Prepare and use the plotting environment:

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py plot_environment
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --plot my_binary.py
```

Inside the script, add `figures=True, theme=bc.PlotTheme(tex=False)` to `export_study`. Math text works without a TeX installation. `tex=True` explicitly requests external LaTeX. The shared paper-inspired palette and theme apply across the standard plots.

Related guides

Goal	Read next
Understand every component in this script	Build a study
Supply your own geometry, frames or state	Bodies and states
Change what is estimated	Parameters
Add data channels, gaps or barycenter uncertainty	Observations
Compare noise, priors or degrees cheaply	Reuse and trades
Inspect signatures and member definitions	Public components

The custom-binary example demonstrates Astropy quantities. The Hera runner is the full paper recipe rather than a short smoke study.

Study setup

A BASCO runner configures physical and statistical components through the public API. This page describes those components and the objects returned during an analysis. The first example provides a complete script.

Unless stated otherwise, snippets below are fragments using `import basco as bc` and the model components created in the quickstart.

Bodies, initial state and gravity

Create two Body objects from an analytic ellipsoid or a checked moment distribution, then a BinaryState. Put them in BinarySystem, including the fixed gravitational constant `G` and a descriptive system name.

```
system = bc.BinarySystem(primary, secondary, state, G=bc.G_SI, name="my binary")
model = bc.BinaryDynamics(system, gravity=bc.HouGravity(mutual_order=6))
```

Mass distribution, reference radii and initial state all affect the physical problem. Bodies and states explains their units, frames and required moment completeness.

Estimated parameters

```
parameters = (
    bc.Parameters(model)
    .estimate_masses()
    .estimate_moments(degrees=(2,))
    .estimate_harmonics(degrees=(3, 4))
    .estimate_initial_state()
)
```

This choice differs from the paper's all-raw degree-4 parameterization. It retains degree-2 inertia and uses independent exterior coefficients at degrees 3 and 4. The model still evaluates order-6 gravity, including fixed higher moments. See parameter choices before changing bases.

Measurements

```
plan = bc.ObservationPlan.uniform(
    stop=3600.0,
    cadence=600.0,
    channels=(
        bc.RelativePosition(sigma=1.0),
        bc.BodyAttitude("primary", sigma=0.01),
        bc.BodyAttitude("secondary", sigma=0.01),
    ),
)
```

These are predicted measurement directions with default independent sigmas. Schedules mask observed rows on this grid while propagation continues. Add barycentric position and nuisance explicitly when that is part of the experiment. Observation configuration covers those choices.

Numerical and statistical settings

```
study = bc.CovarianceStudy(
    model,
    parameters,
    plan,
    integrator=bc.RK4(dt=60.0),
    priors=(),
    solver=bc.SquareRootSolver(),
)
print(study.describe())
```

`describe()` resolves the configuration before expensive propagation. The fixed integration step must be compatible with the output cadence. The constructor's default transport is Hou AD. To use the preserved manual route, pass `transport=bc.NativeAnalyticTransport()` explicitly and choose the native runtime environment.

Noise, priors and solving explains correlated weights, prior producers and the separate projected-solver policy.

Retain the linearized study

```
rows = study.linearize()
result = rows.covariance()
```

`study.run()` performs both steps; repeated calls can repeat propagation. Retaining `rows` lets you change noise, priors and covariance solver without propagating again.

Object	Important contents	Normal use
`study`	Model, resolved parameter intent, observation plan, provider and policies	Describe or produce a linearization
`rows.transport`	Epochs, native states, transition/sensitivity arrays and checked identity	Reuse expensive dynamics
`rows`	Unweighted design rows, exact observation order, coordinate layout, scales, nominal and statistics	Reanalyze assumptions
`result`	Data/posterior support, covariance/nullspace, diagnostics and physical reports	Interpret or export uncertainty
`presentation`	Canonical tables/series/statuses with provenance	Render consistent files and figures

The design-row matrix is `rows.design_rows`; its rows follow `rows.row_labels` / `row_units`, and columns follow `rows.layout.labels` / `units`. Read the layout instead of relying on a remembered mass column index.

Reports and exports

```
print(result.summary())
print(result.mass_properties().summary())
print(result.harmonics(max_degree=4).summary())
```

Inspect support and assumptions before presenting sigmas. A short experiment can validly leave many parameters unresolved. Results and files covers nullspace-aware reports, covariance blocks and standard exports.

Runner structure

For a reusable runner, define a function such as `make_study(...)` with arguments for the model settings being compared. The function composes public components and returns a `CovarianceStudy`. Keep command-line parsing, output paths and printing in the runner.

The Hera runner demonstrates this structure. Its factory independently exposes case, gravity order, estimated degrees, raw/harmonic basis, higher-degree body selection, prior, step, duration and transport. The degree-trade runner reuses that factory and checked transports.

Configuration changes and recomputation

Change	Component to replace	Does it require new propagation?
Measurement precision/correlation	Noise	No
Prior strength/producer	Priors	No
Numerical support strategy	Solver	No
Fewer/reordered existing estimated parameters	`rows.with_parameters(...)`	No, for a compatible subset
Channels or blackout masks at retained epochs	Observation plan + checked transport	No
Mutual gravity order, initial state or integration step	Model/integrator	Yes
New parameter directions or required output epochs	Parameter map/schedule	Requires appropriate new transport

See reuse and trade studies for exact examples and the distinction between conditioning and marginalization.

Bodies and states

BASCO's public physical inputs use metres, kilograms, seconds and radians. Physical-boundary classes also accept compatible Astropy quantities. Internal native translation is kilometre-based; let the codecs convert it. A plausible numerical answer can still be physically wrong when frames or moment normalization are mixed, so keep these conventions with every input and export.

Analytic ellipsoids

UniformEllipsoid is the simplest complete moment source:

```
import basco as bc

primary = bc.Body(
    "primary",
    bc.UniformEllipsoid(axes=[400.0, 350.0, 300.0], density=2200.0),
)
print(primary.mass)
print(primary.inertia)
```

The axes are three positive **semi-axes**, in metres; density is kg/m³. The distribution generates mass-weighted raw moments through degree 6. It has analytic homogeneous-ellipsoid moments, unlike a finite-resolution triangulated ellipsoid.

`Body.mass` is kilograms and `Body.inertia` contains principal inertias in kg m². The body's display name does not replace the physical-coordinate IDs `primary` and `secondary` assigned by its role in the binary.

Explicit moment distributions

MomentDistribution accepts your own centered principal-axis table. A key `(l, m, n)` represents:

$$T_{lmn} = \int x^l y^m z^n \, dm, \qquad [T_{lmn}] = \mathrm{kg\,m}^{l+m+n}.$$

`(0, 0, 0)` is the mass. First moments and degree-2 products of inertia vanish in the required frame. The three positive diagonal second moments determine principal inertia through sums, for example `Izz = T200 + T020`.

For a safe miniature example, start with a complete analytic table and make the roles explicit:

```
ellipsoid = bc.UniformEllipsoid([400.0, 350.0, 300.0], 2200.0)
distribution = bc.MomentDistribution(
    raw_moments=ellipsoid.moments(order=6),
    reference_radius=ellipsoid.reference_radius,
    bounding_radius=ellipsoid.bounding_radius,
    characteristic_length=ellipsoid.characteristic_length,
    available_degree=6,
    missing="error",
)
primary = bc.Body("primary", distribution)
```

Replace the moment table only when its units, frame, centering and degree completeness are known. `missing="zero"` is an explicit scientific declaration that omitted nonstructural moments are zero. It is not an automatic repair for an incomplete data file.

Field	Role
`reference_radius`	Fixed radius used for harmonic normalization/reporting
`bounding_radius`	Enclosing sphere used in non-overlap/separation checks
`characteristic_length`	Positive numerical coordinate scale
`available_degree`	Completeness of the supplied nominal moment table

These radii/lengths can differ. Changing a report radius is a convention change that must travel with the coefficients and covariance.

For OBJ ingestion, mesh alignment and fresh shape campaigns, use shapes and Kaula priors. In particular, geometric volume moments are not already mass-weighted moments.

Binary state convention

BinaryState contains six physical fields:

Field	Meaning	Unit
`position`	Inertial secondary-minus-primary position, expressed in primary-body components	m
`velocity`	Inertial relative velocity, expressed in primary-body components	m/s
`omega_primary`	Primary inertial angular velocity, expressed in primary components	rad/s
`omega_secondary`	Secondary inertial angular velocity, expressed in primary components	rad/s
`A_to_N`	Rotation mapping primary-body components to inertial components	dimensionless
`B_to_A`	Rotation mapping secondary-body components to primary-body components	dimensionless

`velocity` is **not** the time derivative of `position` in the rotating primary frame. Similarly, the secondary spin is not supplied in secondary-body components. Rotate those inputs explicitly before building the state.

Both input matrices must be proper rotations. The initial state is a physical input, not an arbitrary 30-element vector. An order-6 mutual model also needs adequate separation relative to the declared body bounds.

Binary system and gravitational constant

The quickstart's complete `primary`, `secondary` and `state` objects compose as:

```
system = bc.BinarySystem(
    primary, secondary, state,
    G=bc.G_SI,
    name="my binary",
)
model = bc.BinaryDynamics(system, gravity=bc.HouGravity(mutual_order=6))
```

`G` is fixed in this model. Mass reports transform its mass covariance into GM covariance using that fixed value; they do not estimate uncertainty in the gravitational constant.

Native30 and physical18

The retained integration representation has 30 components: translation/spins and two nine-entry rotation matrices. `BinaryState.to_native()` and `BinaryState.from_native(...)` own its codec. Export metadata names each native axis and its unit convention.

Physical state uncertainty has 18 coordinates: relative position, relative velocity, two spins and two three-component local attitude errors. physical_lift and physical_dual map between those tangents and native entries. retract_native applies a finite physical state update using a consistent attitude retraction.

`BinaryState.from_native(native, project=True)` explicitly projects matrix roundoff to SO(3); it is used when passing propagated arc-end states into the next nominal arc. It is not a general license to repair arbitrary invalid attitude inputs or perturb nine DCM entries independently for validation.

Source owners: models.py, coordinates.py, state.py. Continue with estimated parameter coordinates.

Gravity and estimated parameters

Two independent choices define an experiment: **which gravity terms affect the nominal motion**, and **which physical quantities are uncertain estimated parameters**. A degree-6 nominal model does not imply degree-6 estimation. Fixed nominal terms still affect motion and can affect a mass derivative.

Mutual gravity order

```
model = bc.BinaryDynamics(system, gravity=bc.HouGravity(mutual_order=6))
```

This fragment assumes `system` from the quickstart. HouGravity supports total mutual orders 2, 4 and 6. The distributions must provide complete nominal moment data through the selected order. Keep the gravity order in run labels, configuration and comparison captions.

Mutual order is the truncation of the two-body expansion. It should not be confused with the maximum degree present in a coefficient report, shape ensemble or independent estimated parameter basis.

Parameter selection

Parameters belongs to a specific model. Its chained calls retain selection order:

```
parameters = (
    bc.Parameters(model)
    .estimate_masses(bodies="both")
    .estimate_moments(bodies="both", degrees=(2,))
    .estimate_harmonics(bodies="both", degrees=(3, 4))
    .estimate_initial_state()
)
resolved = parameters.resolve()
print(resolved.labels)
print(resolved.units)
print(resolved.scales)
```

`bodies` can be `"primary"`, `"secondary"` or `"both"`. Omitted quantities are fixed at the supplied nominal. Omit `estimate_initial_state()` only when a conditional, fixed-initial-state analysis is intended.

Selection	Independent physical coordinates	Unit
`estimate_masses()`	Each selected mass	kg

Selection	Independent physical coordinates	Unit
`estimate_moments(degrees=(2,))`	Three diagonal mass-normalized moments per selected body	m^2
`estimate_moments(degrees=(3, 4))`	Complete normalized raw degree-3/4 moments, including trace directions	m^3 / m^4
`estimate_harmonics(degrees=(3, 4))`	Independent unnormalized exterior C/S coefficients with a declared trace complement	dimensionless
`estimate_initial_state()`	18 physical initial-state errors	Mixed SI/radians

Raw and harmonic selections cannot overlap for the same body and degree. Degree-2 harmonic-only selection is rejected because the rotational equations need the third inertia coordinate. Independent degree-5/6 estimated parameters, and estimated parameter degrees above the active gravity order, are unsupported.

Raw versus exterior parameterizations

The paper reproduction uses:

```
parameters = (
    bc.Parameters(model)
    .estimate_masses()
    .estimate_moments(degrees=(2, 3, 4))
    .estimate_initial_state()
)
```

There are 58 physical estimated parameters: two masses plus 28 selected normalized moments per body. Coestimating the initial state adds 18, and a three-component barycenter offset/rate adds 6 observation-nuisance coordinates: **82 joint coordinates**.

The mixed degree-2/raw plus degree-3/4/harmonic basis in the first example has 40 physical coordinates: two masses, three degree-2 moments per body, and 7 degree-3 plus 9 degree-4 coefficients per body. With the same state/barycenter treatment it has **64 joint coordinates**.

These are different inverse problems. Raw higher-degree moments can contain exterior trace null directions. Priors that constrain such directions must be stated. The exterior coordinate map uses a fixed trace-complement gauge, rather than making the missing raw directions implicitly measurable.

Parameter normalization and mass derivatives

Raw estimated parameter coordinates are normalized by body mass, not radius. A degree- `n` normalized raw moment has units m^n. Harmonics are dimensionless at a fixed reference radius. Their public report uses unnormalized C/S conventions; Kaula ensembles use a separately declared normalized convention and map it explicitly.

Changing a mass scales all retained mass-weighted moments of that body at fixed normalized shape, including higher nominal moments that are not independently estimated. `ResolvedParameters.raw_jacobian` records this full physical map; `raw_slots` records raw moment order. Do not implement a custom mass variation by changing only the monopole.

Scaling and layouts

Positive characteristic scales support numerical conditioning even when a coefficient's nominal value is zero. They introduce no statistical knowledge. CoordinateLayout records ordered labels, units, scales and `n_state`, the prefix count of local state/nuisance coordinates.

Use `resolved.labels`, the joint `rows.layout`, and named covariance access rather than depending on numeric positions. Results explains `covariance_for(...)` and nullspace-aware derived transforms.

Changing estimated degree after propagation

When a retained linearization already contains the needed directions, a compatible subset can be selected with `rows.with_parameters(...)`. The omitted coordinates are then **conditioned on their nominal values**; they are not marginalized. Priors reset unless supplied explicitly for the new layout.

Changing nominal gravity order always changes dynamics and requires new matching transport. Reuse and trades gives examples of both operations.

The Hera degree-trade example distinguishes the paper's primary-only higher-degree no-prior case from a symmetric both-body experiment. Preserve that distinction when comparing Figure 5.

Shapes and Kaula priors

BASCO separates geometry, shape sampling, coefficient statistics, prior construction and plotting. A shape campaign does not automatically change the gravity model or estimated degree. A Kaula-style prior is an empirical statistical assumption derived from an explicitly defined ensemble.

Body moments from an OBJ mesh

```
import basco as bc

mesh = bc.TriangleMesh.from_obj("primary.obj", scale_to_m=1.0)
distribution = mesh.to_distribution(
    mass_kg=5.2e11,
    max_degree=6,
    reference_radius_m=390.0,
)
primary = bc.Body("primary", distribution)
```

The file path must exist. `scale_to_m=1000.0` is appropriate for a kilometre-based OBJ. TriangleMesh requires a closed, consistently outward-wound triangular surface. Checks cover topology, degenerate faces and positive signed volume; they do not certify arbitrary self-intersection freedom.

`to_distribution()` recenters and principal-aligns the mesh, integrates mass-weighted moments, checks structural residuals and clears only permitted roundoff. This supplies the centered/principal-axis representation required by both Hou routes. The fixed harmonic radius and enclosing bound remain distinct.

For a self-contained generated geometry:

```
mesh = bc.TriangleMesh.ellipsoid([400.0, 350.0, 300.0], subdivisions=2)
distribution = mesh.to_distribution(mass_kg=5.2e11, max_degree=6)
```

This is a finite-resolution triangulation. `UniformEllipsoid` gives analytic moments and should not be expected to agree exactly with every coarse mesh.

Volume moments and mass moments

`mesh.moments(max_degree=4, mass_kg=...)` produces mass-weighted moments in kg m^n without automatically changing the frame. Omitting `mass_kg` produces geometric volume moments in m^{n+3}. Those geometric moments cannot be passed as if they already included density.

`mesh.aligned()` returns center-of-mass/principal-axis geometry. The frame convention matters both for body construction and for whether perturbed ensemble members are realigned.

Shape-sampling example

The following continues from the generated mesh/distribution above. It creates four perturbed copies as a compact API demonstration, not a statistically mature prior:

```
sampler = bc.RadialShapeSampler(
    roughness_m=2.0,
    correlation_lengths_m=(50.0, 100.0),
    copies_per_length=2,
    seed=17,
)
ensemble = bc.build_shape_ensemble(
    mesh.aligned(),
    sampler,
    reference_radius_m=distribution.reference_radius,
    body="primary",
    max_degree=4,
    density_models=(),
    realign=True,
)
rule = bc.KaulaRule.fit(
    ensemble,
    fit_degrees=(2, 3, 4),
    apply_degrees=(2, 3, 4),
    lock_exponent=None,
)
print(rule.sigma("C20"))
ensemble.to_jsonl("my-primary-ensemble.jsonl")
```

RadialShapeSampler uses seeded spherical-harmonic radial fields with degree 0/1 removed and rescaled to requested RMS roughness. The default seed convention distinguishes the actual requested correlation lengths. `legacy_integer_length_seed=True` explicitly selects the integer-length seed convention used for paper reproduction.

`realign=True` recenters/principal-aligns each sampled shape. `realign=False` retains the paper's perturbation-frame convention. This choice changes the statistics and must remain in provenance.

Resolution, correlation lengths, roughness, sample count and fitted degree range are scientific campaign settings. Large high-resolution degree-12 campaigns can be expensive; sampling degree 12 does not enable degree-12 Hou propagation or independent estimated parameters.

Optional interior variations

DensityVariation offers mass-preserving `"core"`, `"shell"` and `"torus"` alternatives, with contrast and region dimensions. Supply them through `density_models=(...)`:

```
interiors = (
    bc.DensityVariation("core", contrast=0.2),
    bc.DensityVariation("shell", contrast=-0.2),
)
```

This defines alternatives only; pass `interiors` to a new `build_shape_ensemble(...)` call to use them. Check region containment in the actual body. A generic mesh check does not prove an arbitrary core or torus lies wholly inside it.

Coefficient statistics and fitted laws

KaulaRule fits independent zonal and nonzonal coefficient-magnitude power laws. The shape-member RMS informs the fit, and adopted upper amplitudes cover retained shape/interior members. These magnitudes are not a cloud of nominal-subtracted estimation residuals.

`fit_degrees` selects the degrees used for fitting; `apply_degrees` selects degrees receiving prior sigmas. `lock_exponent=2.0` adopts that exponent only when it lies within the fitted one-sigma interval. It does not force every fitted law to follow degree^{-2}.

The ensemble and rules use **geodesy 4-pi normalized**, dimensionless coefficients at an explicit fixed radius. Ordinary `result.harmonics()` reports **unnormalized** C/S. The prior producer performs the conversion; do not manually paste normalized sigmas into an unnormalized covariance.

Prior construction

After composing `model`, `parameters` and `measurements` for the corresponding body:

```
shape_prior = bc.KaulaPrior(
    parameters,
    {"primary": rule},
    raw_moment_priors=True,
)
study = bc.CovarianceStudy(
    model,
    parameters,
    measurements,
    integrator=bc.RK4(dt=60.0),
    priors=(shape_prior,),
)
```

The rule radius must match the model radius. Body keys may be `primary` / `secondary` or `A` / `B`. A rule for one body adds no prior to the other. No mass, initial-state or barycenter prior is implied.

`raw_moment_priors=True` adds the paper's separate independent raw-moment constraints using RMS touching-coefficient sigmas. It is a modeling choice, not an inverse transform of harmonic covariance. Set it false for harmonic knowledge alone and retain any resulting trace/inertia null directions in the reported results.

Saving and plotting

```
loaded = bc.CoefficientEnsemble.from_jsonl("my-primary-ensemble.jsonl")
saved_rule = rule.to_dict()
reloaded_rule = bc.KaulaRule.from_dict(saved_rule)

from basco.kaula_plotting import render_kaula
render_kaula(
    {"primary": rule},
    "my-kaula-figures",
    theme=bc.PlotTheme(tex=False),
)
```

The plotting call needs a rule retaining its ensemble and a new output path. It renders existing fitted data; it performs no propagation or fresh sampling. Older JSONL files without metadata require explicit `body` and `reference_radius_m` when loaded.

The Hera Kaula example separates replay/refitting of captured paper clouds from `--fresh` sampling. Label those activities accurately. The pinned benchmark prior remains available for exact historical reproduction; the generic components above support a new binary's own campaign.

Measurements and schedules

An ObservationPlan describes predicted measurement directions, their default uncertainties and their times. It is independent of the gravity kernel, derivative provider and covariance solver. Ordinary plans currently use positive elapsed epochs on one uniform grid.

The snippets below use `import basco as bc` and NumPy as `np`. Their `model` and `parameters` come from the quickstart.

Built-in measurement channels

Channel	Prediction directions	Default/public units
RelativePosition	Three inertial components of secondary-minus-primary position	m
BodyAttitude	Three local inertial attitude prediction directions for primary or secondary	rad
PrimaryBarycentricPosition	Three inertial primary-position components relative to the binary barycenter, plus optional nuisance	m

```
channels = (
    bc.RelativePosition(sigma=1.0),
    bc.BodyAttitude("primary", sigma=np.deg2rad(1.0)),
    bc.BodyAttitude("secondary", sigma=np.deg2rad(1.0)),
    bc.PrimaryBarycentricPosition(
        sigma=1.0,
        nuisance=bc.PolynomialBias("barycenter", degree=1),
    ),
)
plan = bc.ObservationPlan.uniform(
    stop=86400.0,
    cadence=900.0,
    channels=channels,
)
```

Each built-in channel takes a scalar sigma. For component-specific weights, supply `DiagonalNoise` in the assembled row order, or implement a custom channel. Each sigma must be positive and finite. Component labels across channels must be unique. A separate noise model can replace these default independent weights after linearization.

`BodyAttitude` supplies the covariance tangent. A general adapter for actual measured-attitude residuals is unfinished. Adding a covariance channel is not equivalent to completing observed-data fitting for that channel.

Didymos position relative to the center of mass

For inertial relative position `rho_N`, the primary's prediction is:

$$\boldsymbol{y}_A(t) = -\frac{M_B}{M_A + M_B}\boldsymbol{\rho}_N(t) + \boldsymbol{R}_0 + (t - t_{\mathrm{ref}})\boldsymbol{V}_0.$$

At fixed relative state, its direct mass derivatives include:

$$\frac{\partial \boldsymbol{y}_A}{\partial M_A} = \frac{M_B}{(M_A + M_B)^2}\boldsymbol{\rho}_N, \qquad \frac{\partial \boldsymbol{y}_A}{\partial M_B} = -\frac{M_A}{(M_A + M_B)^2}\boldsymbol{\rho}_N.$$

The implementation retains these **direct** terms in addition to propagated mass sensitivity. observations.py owns the value and derivative maps. This is the modular channel used in the reproduced Hera study.

Omitting `nuisance` conditions on a known barycenter. PolynomialBias with `degree=1` instead coestimates a free three-component offset and rate, adding six unknowns without an implicit prior. Its `reference_epoch` is seconds. Polynomial terms use `(t - t_ref)**k / k!`, so degree-2 coefficients represent acceleration in m/s² rather than an arbitrary quadratic coefficient.

Epochs and row order

The first measurement is at one cadence after arc start; there is no observation at `t=0`, and no invented final observation when duration is not on the cadence boundary. Integration still retains its own initial state and the output states needed by the observation plan.

```
print(plan.epochs)
print(plan.visibility())
print(plan.row_sigmas())
```

Observation rows are ordered by epoch, then visible channels in the supplied order, then components within each channel. `rows.row_labels` and `rows.row_units` are authoritative after assembly. Correlated covariance and residual vectors must follow that exact order.

Add a recurring blackout

```
plan = bc.ObservationPlan.uniform(
    stop=14 * 86400.0,
    cadence=900.0,
    channels=channels,
    schedule=bc.PeriodicBlackout(period=86400.0, duration=8 * 3600.0),
)
```

This removes observations during the blackout, while the binary continues propagating. A schedule masks the existing output grid; it does not create new epochs or accelerate dynamics by skipping gaps.

Per-channel cadence

```
channels = (
    bc.RelativePosition(sigma=1.0),
    bc.Scheduled(
        bc.BodyAttitude("secondary", sigma=0.01),
        bc.Every(period=1800.0),
    ),
)
```

With a 900-second plan grid, `Every(1800.0)` retains every other matching epoch for that stream. The plan schedule and stream schedule must both permit an observation.

Schedule	Meaning
Always	All existing epochs
Every	Epochs matching a repeated period/offset
Periodic	Observed intervals of a repeated period
PeriodicBlackout	Complement of repeated blackout intervals
Windows	Union of half-open `[start, stop)` observing windows
AllOf, AnyOf, Not	Combine schedules, also via `&`, `|` and `~`

```
passes = bc.Windows(((3600.0, 7200.0), (14400.0, 18000.0)))
allowed = passes & bc.PeriodicBlackout(period=86400.0, duration=1800.0)
```

`Windows.around(centers, before=..., after=...)` builds pass windows around supplied centers. Schedules evaluate elapsed mission time, including `schedule_offset`; multi-arc composition supplies each arc's offset so a daily gap does not accidentally restart every arc.

Reuse and custom measurements

Changing channels or masks on the same retained grid can reuse checked transport. See reuse and trades. A new measurement can implement the ObservationChannel structural contract without inheriting a base class. Its local prediction derivative and direct parameter derivative must both be explicit; a missing derivative is not assumed zero.

The extension chapter includes a range-channel example and the boundaries of custom-observation AD. Multi-arc studies explain continuous nominal trajectories with independent local estimated states.

Noise, priors and solvers

The observing geometry supplies information directions; noise determines their weight; priors add independent stated knowledge; the solver determines finite-precision support. Keep these four roles separate when comparing experiments.

For parameters held uncertain in the estimator, and for uncertainty versus observation cutoff or physical time, see consider parameters and covariance histories. That analysis keeps the external uncertainty separate from estimator prior information.

Snippets assume the `study`, `rows`, `primary`, NumPy and `bc` objects from the quickstart.

Independent measurement noise

Without an override, channel sigmas define independent scalar observation errors. After propagating once, replace that model with DiagonalNoise:

```
baseline = rows.covariance()
twice_the_sigma = rows.covariance(
    noise=bc.DiagonalNoise(2.0 * rows.sigmas),
)
```

This changes standard deviations, not variances, and performs no new dynamics. `rows.sigmas` follows the actual retained observation rows, including schedule masks.

Correlated measurement noise

CorrelatedNoise accepts a finite symmetric positive-definite covariance and uses Cholesky whitening. Its rows and columns follow the full scalar observation order and mixed physical row units.

For a small study, this example adds correlation only between its first two scalar rows:

```
measurement_covariance = np.diag(rows.sigmas**2)
measurement_covariance[0, 1] = measurement_covariance[1, 0] = (
    0.2 * rows.sigmas[0] * rows.sigmas[1]
)
correlated = rows.covariance(
    noise=bc.CorrelatedNoise(measurement_covariance),
)
```

This is an API illustration, not a recommended physical correlation model. A dense full observation covariance can be large. Custom NoiseModel implementations may provide appropriate structured whitening, but must whiten vectors and matrices consistently and fully describe their settings.

A named Gaussian prior

GaussianPrior identifies independent coordinates by labels and units:

```
mass_prior = bc.GaussianPrior(
    name="independent primary mass knowledge",
    labels=("primary.mass",),
    units=("kg",),
    covariance=[[(0.05 * primary.mass)**2]],
    source="external mass constraint",
)
posterior = rows.covariance(priors=(mass_prior,))
```

The example states a 5% prior standard deviation. It does not alter what the observations measured. Replacing `priors` replaces the complete retained set for that analysis; it does not silently append to it. Use `priors=()` for data-only analysis.

A multi-coordinate prior preserves off-diagonal covariance. A zero covariance is not a way to fix an unknown; remove the estimated parameter when conditioning on an exact value. Unknown labels, wrong units and duplicate prior information identities are errors.

Prior mean and reference

For covariance alone, an omitted prior mean centers the prior on the nominal. For repeated nonlinear estimation, use a fixed explicit physical prior mean and update the reference at each iterate. Centering a prior on every new iterate changes the statistical problem.

For example, a fixed prior mean can be written:

```
mass_prior = bc.GaussianPrior(
    "external primary mass",
    labels=("primary.mass",),
    units=("kg",),
    covariance=[[(0.05 * primary.mass)**2]],
    mean=[primary.mass],
)
```

PriorBlock supports knowledge about mapped physical quantities. It carries a Jacobian, column and row layouts, a noise model, mean/reference and source. IndependentPriors composes independent producers while retaining each block's correlations and provenance.

KaulaPrior is a reusable physical prior producer, explained in shapes and Kaula. Multi-arc shared priors belong once on the global study, not once per arc.

Joint square-root solver

SquareRootSolver is the default. It uses scaled SVD support and QR covariance/correction algebra. It diagnoses data and posterior support, retains null directions and returns full joint covariance only when supported.

```
joint = rows.covariance(solver=bc.SquareRootSolver())
print(joint.summary())
```

Characteristic scales are physical column scales for conditioning. They are not prior sigmas. Zero nominal coefficients still need positive scales. Inspect `rows.layout.scales` and the singular spectrum when rank is sensitive.

Nuisance-projected solver

NuisanceProjectedSolver eliminates the local state/nuisance block with Householder QR before diagnosing marginal physical information. It matches the documented Hera convention:

```
projected = rows.covariance(solver=bc.NuisanceProjectedSolver())
```

This strategy requires numerically usable local columns and applies an explicit nuisance-condition guard. It does not make an unobservable local block safe to eliminate. Joint and projected strategies can make different declared support decisions in ill-conditioned problems; a different finite answer is a reason to inspect diagnostics, basis and refinement rather than choose the prettier result.

Both strategies preserve prior provenance and expose common support diagnostics, including `numerical_support_loss_after_prior`. This diagnostic can identify loss/rotation of numerically retained data support after adding prior rows; a mathematically informative prior does not guarantee every finite-precision truncation behaves ideally.

Numerical rank thresholds

`rank_rtol` controls a numerical support threshold. It is not a prior and does not repair observability. Record the selected policy with results, and compare thresholds/bases/refinement when conclusions depend on it. Never turn a threshold until an expected sigma appears.

The next chapter, reading results, explains data versus posterior rank, supported quantities and full cross covariance. The solver source and projected source expose the actual support policies.

Consider parameters and covariance histories

Consider analysis quantifies the effect of parameters held at nominal values in an estimator. Covariance histories answer either when observations constrain a quantity or how uncertainty evolves after an information set is fixed. BASCO implements these operations separately and retains complete state, mass, field and consider cross covariance.

These operations reuse a LinearizedStudy. Changing noise, priors, consider roles or history cutoffs does not propagate the dynamics again. The source linearization must already contain every required derivative direction. Changing the gravity model, nominal bodies or derivative directions requires a compatible new linearization.

Choose estimated, fixed or considered parameters

Role	Statistical treatment
Estimated	Fit the coordinate from observations and any independent prior equations.
Fixed	Hold the coordinate exactly at its nominal value; assign no uncertainty.
Considered	Hold the coordinate at its nominal value in the estimator while propagating an explicitly supplied uncertainty.

Consider coordinates are selected from the full retained layout. Every remaining coordinate is estimated, including retained initial-state and observation-nuisance coordinates. Changing the role does not change the nominal dynamics or the units of a coordinate. Parameters and gravity order explains how to retain the desired physical derivative directions before assigning uncertainty roles.

The following fragment assumes `rows` and `bc` from the Hera study. It holds the primary mass at nominal while accounting for an **illustrative**, independent external mass uncertainty of 1%. That percentage is a demonstration input, not a measured Hera constraint.

```
mass_index = rows.layout.labels.index("primary.mass")
mass_uncertainty = bc.ConsiderParameters(
    labels=("primary.mass",),
    units=("kg",),
    covariance=[[(0.01 * rows.nominal[mass_index]) ** 2]],
    name="external primary mass",
    source="illustrative independent 1% mass uncertainty",
)
considered = rows.covariance(consider=mass_uncertainty, priors=())
print(considered.summary())
print(considered.mass_properties().summary())
```

`priors=()` deliberately requests no estimated-parameter priors in this illustration. A degree-4 fit without such priors may leave some combinations unresolved; report availability identifies that outcome. To retain independent field knowledge, supply the intended prior producers explicitly. Do not represent the same external uncertainty both as a consider covariance and as independent prior information.

ConsiderParameters accepts a correlated positive-semidefinite covariance. Its row and column order follows `labels`, and each entry has the product of the corresponding physical units. Labels must exist in `rows.layout`; units must match exactly. Zero variance is allowed. The consider distribution remains unchanged by the observations.

`ConsiderParameters.from_priors(priors, layout, nominal, labels=...)` constructs an external distribution from centered independent prior equations for the selected coordinates. It combines mapped equations and preserves correlations. It rejects equations coupled to outside coordinates, shifted means and incomplete rank; it does not silently condition an arbitrary joint distribution. Remove those same selected equations from the estimator when using the external distribution. The Hera runner shows this separation for degree-3/4 moments.

Equations and error sign

Let the whitened observation and permitted prior equations be

$$y = Ax + Bc + \epsilon, \qquad E[\epsilon\epsilon^T] = I, \quad E[cc^T] = C, \quad E[\epsilon c^T] = 0.$$

`x` contains the estimated deviations and `c` the true deviations from the fixed consider nominal. With error defined as **truth minus estimate**, a full-column-rank batch estimator has

$$e_x = x - \hat{x} = -A^+\epsilon + Sc, \qquad S = -A^+B,$$

$$P_f = A^+(A^+)^T, \qquad P_{xx} = P_f + SCS^T, \qquad P_{xc} = SC, \qquad P_{cc} = C.$$

`Pf` is conditional covariance with the consider coordinates known exactly. `Pxx` includes their effect on the stated estimator. The derivative of the fitted estimate with respect to a true consider perturbation has the opposite sign to `S`. The distinction matters for cross covariance and downstream outputs.

For output error `Jx ex + Jc c`, BASCO evaluates

$$P_q = J_x P_f J_x^T + (J_x S + J_c) C (J_x S + J_c)^T.$$

The direct `Jc` term is essential. In the scalar example `y = x + c + noise`, `S = -1`. The output `x + c` has `Jx = Jc = 1`, so its consider contribution cancels. Mapping only `Pxx` would miss this cancellation. The numerical implementation uses scaled square-root solves; these equations do not prescribe forming normal equations.

This is a **fixed-estimator batch error-covariance analysis**. It does not change the estimator gain to include consider uncertainty and does not implement a recursive Schmidt filter. All data and prior equation errors are assumed independent of the consider error. A coupled prior can express `x - L c = u` with an independent residual `u`; arbitrary correlations between measurement noise and `c` need an additional explicit statistical model.

Prior equations retain both their estimated and consider derivative columns. A prior involving only considered coordinates does not update `C`. Adding the external `C` as more information would change the analysis and may double count knowledge.

Read a consider result

ConsiderResult retains the full original layout so physical reports include direct consider effects:

Attribute	Meaning
`layout`	Full source order, including estimated and considered coordinates.
`estimated_layout`	Coordinate order actually fitted.
`information_result` or `conditional`	Conditional estimated-space covariance, spectra, ranks and null directions.
`sensitivity`	Estimated-error response `S`, with estimated rows and consider columns.
`estimated_covariance`	Estimated-coordinate covariance including consider uncertainty, when fully available.
`estimated_consider_covariance`	Error cross covariance `SC`, when fully available.

Attribute	Meaning
`joint_covariance`	Complete estimated/consider covariance in the original layout, when available.

The consider result's ranks describe the **estimated space**, not a fit of the considered coordinates. `full_rank` means all estimated coordinates are supported conditional on `c`. It does not mean the observations estimated `c`. Use `summary()` or `estimated_layout` when interpreting the rank denominator.

`mass_properties()`, `degree2()`, `harmonics(...)` and `derived(...)` use the complete error covariance. When the estimated problem is deficient, only output Jacobians that annihilate its nullspace receive finite uncertainty. A pure considered output can remain supported even if an estimated direction is unresolved. Adding `c` cannot make an unidentified estimated coordinate observable.

Accumulate observations at a fixed reference epoch

An accumulated history uses observations with epoch at or before each selected cutoff. All results describe the **same reference-epoch coordinates**. A cutoff is the last allowed observation epoch; it is not the epoch to which the state covariance has been propagated.

```
import numpy as np

cutoffs = np.linspace(rows.transport.epochs[0], rows.transport.epochs[-1], 17)
history = rows.covariance_history(
    checkpoints=cutoffs,
    consider=mass_uncertainty,
    priors=(),
    solver=bc.SquareRootSolver(),
)
mass_history = history.report(lambda result: result.mass_properties())
```

This fragment explicitly chooses the joint square-root rank policy to allow early unsupported directions. It is not the paper's nuisance-projected solver policy. For a Hera reproduction using NuisanceProjectedSolver, choose checkpoints after the local state/nuisance data block becomes identifiable. That solver can reject a prior-only or short prefix; the error identifies the cutoff, scalar row count and selected solver. BASCO does not silently change solvers or thresholds to manufacture finite uncertainties.

CovarianceHistory contains `epochs`, `results`, scalar-row `counts`, `reference_epoch_s` and provenance `metadata`. Default checkpoints are sorted distinct observation epochs. Every simultaneous row enters together. Explicit cutoffs may precede the first observation, producing prior-only results when the selected solver supports them. Empty data default to one reference-epoch, prior-only result. Choose a modest explicit checkpoint set to limit repeated factorizations.

Each checkpoint repeats the selected batch solve exactly on its included rows. Independent priors enter once per checkpoint. For correlated observation noise, BASCO selects the original covariance marginal `R[I,I]` before whitening; it does not slice a globally whitened design that may contain future information. Custom noise providers must implement an explicit `subset(indices)` returning that marginal in the requested row order.

`history.report(callback)` applies the same physical report to every prefix. `history.derived(labels, values, units, jacobian, ...)` applies a fixed custom reference-epoch output map. Both return a DerivedCovarianceHistory, with per-checkpoint values, covariance, status, Jacobians and `sigma`.

At full rank and fixed support, adding independent information cannot increase ordinary conditional covariance. Numerical support can change at relative rank cutoffs. **Total consider covariance can increase** as the estimator's sensitivity to fixed uncertain parameters changes; monotonic improvement is not guaranteed.

Propagate one fixed information set

A propagated history holds the data set fixed and maps its covariance to physical output epochs. This answers a different question from accumulating observations. For example, the following computes uncertainty in the binary relative position using all information in `considered`:

```
relative_position_history = rows.propagated_covariance(
    considered,
    bc.RelativePosition(sigma=1.0),
)
primary_position_history = rows.propagated_covariance(
    considered,
    bc.PrimaryBarycentricPosition(sigma=1.0),
)
```

These are ideal observable **error** histories: nominal values default to zero, and the channel's observation sigma is not added. The primary barycentric map includes direct mass-ratio dependence. Use channels without instrument nuisance biases. The result must belong to the same retained linearization. State, parameter and consider cross terms remain in the map.

The helper uses the retained transport grid and performs no additional dynamics integration. Built-in solvers retain a supported covariance factor directly from their square-root calculation. The new history mapper forms `(J F)(J F).T` from that factor, preserving the selected support. It does not reconstruct a factor by decomposing a previously rounded covariance. This matters for long, sensitive trajectories where large state/parameter terms can cancel in `J P J.T`, producing negative variances or inaccurate cross covariance. Symmetrizing that answer would not recover the lost information.

`CovarianceResult.derived_stable(...)` exposes the same factor-based map for a standalone output; the original `derived(...)` numerical path is retained for compatibility. Consider outputs combine the conditional source factor with the independent consider factor, retaining direct-parameter cancellations. A custom result without a source factor can still use its own `derived(...)`; history metadata records that the stable factor mapping is unavailable. Mapped records reject negative variances and materially asymmetric or indefinite covariance rather than clip eigenvalues or add artificial noise. A finite covariance alone does not establish numerical accuracy.

For an explicitly supplied full-source map, use propagate_covariance. This interface fragment assumes the caller has computed `output_epochs`, `output_values` and `output_jacobians` for the declared quantity:

```
mapped = bc.propagate_covariance(
    considered,
    epochs=output_epochs,
    jacobians=output_jacobians,
    labels=("custom.x", "custom.y", "custom.z"),
    units=("m", "m", "m"),
    values=output_values,
    information_cutoff_s=last_observation_epoch,
    reference_epoch_s=rows.transport.epochs[0],
    conventions={"definition": "caller-defined physical position"},
)
```

For `K` epochs and `N` full source coordinates, the Jacobians have shape `(K, 3, N)` and nominal values `(K, 3)`. Columns include all initial-state, nuisance, estimated-parameter and considered-parameter directions in `result.layout` order. Include both transported sensitivities and direct parameter dependence. Known source reference/cutoff epochs cannot be relabeled inconsistently.

`information_cutoff_s` records the fixed information set; it does not select observations or add measurements. Mapping an all-data batch result to earlier physical epochs uses future observations relative to those epochs. It is not a causal filter history. No process noise is introduced.

To map an earlier information set to later retained epochs, pass a prefix result instead, for example `rows.propagated_covariance(history.results[5], bc.RelativePosition())`. Its known cutoff is retained automatically. This is a fixed-data prediction within the transport interval; it performs no later measurement updates.

`covariance[k]` stores all output cross terms **within** epoch `k`; covariance between different epochs is not stored. Null directions remain unavailable at every mapped epoch unless the output annihilates them. Relative percentage uncertainty is undefined for zero nominal values, so plot ideal error-coordinate histories in absolute units.

Export and plot histories

Mapped histories use a separate atomic export, with human-readable axes/provenance, a long-form uncertainty table and checksummed numerical arrays:

```
from pathlib import Path

folder = bc.export_covariance_history(
    mass_history,
    Path("results/hera-consider-mass-history"),
    title="Hera mass uncertainty by observation cutoff",
)
restored = bc.read_covariance_history(folder)
```

```
hera-consider-mass-history/
  README.md
  history.json
  uncertainties.csv
  manifest.json
  arrays/
    metadata.json
    epochs_s.npy
    nominal_values.npy
    covariance.npy
    jacobians.npy
```

export_covariance_history accepts a mapped history; call `.report(...)` or `.derived(...)` first for accumulated results. Existing destinations are refused. read_covariance_history verifies hashes before reconstructing the immutable record. Unavailable covariance entries remain NaN in numerical arrays; CSV uncertainty cells are empty with explicit status. Export performs no solve, propagation or derivative validation.

Use `export_study(rows, result, ..., include_factor=True)` to preserve the full source factor alongside its covariance and nullspace. A saved rounded covariance alone may not reproduce stable new physical maps on a long chaotic trajectory. The Hera runner requests the factor explicitly; ordinary export defaults remain compatible.

Figures use the ordinary BASCO renderer and theme:

```
from basco.history_plotting import covariance_history_plot
from basco.plotting import render

definition = covariance_history_plot(
    {"External primary mass uncertainty": mass_history},
    labels=("primary.mass", "secondary.mass"),
    relative=True,
    time_unit="h",
    quantity_names={"primary.mass": "Didymos mass", "secondary.mass": "Dimorphos mass"},
)
figure_folder = Path("results/hera-history-figures")
figure_folder.mkdir(parents=True, exist_ok=True)
render(None, figure_folder, bc.PlotTheme(tex=False), plots=(definition,))
```

covariance_history_plot compares named histories, gives each requested quantity its own panel and preserves unavailable directions as gaps. Use `relative=False` for absolute standard deviations. `time_unit` accepts seconds, hours or days. Accumulated-data and fixed-information histories require separate figures. The plot constructor returns a reusable `PlotDefinition`; the renderer controls file formats and the common scientific style. External TeX is optional through `PlotTheme(tex=True)` when installed.

Hera example and numerical evidence

The runnable Hera uncertainty example composes the same public operations with the Didymos–Dimorphos model. The original Hera reproduction remains the reference for the paper's settings and Table 2 results. Assigning consider roles creates a new statistical experiment; it does not by itself reproduce a new paper figure or establish a landing footprint.

The accepted example uses **AC3 full tumbling, degree-6 Hou gravity, derivative directions through degree 4, RK4 75 s and the paper's nominal 16-orbit interval**. The 900 s grid provides 8,724 scalar observations through 654300 s. The coordinate reference is 0 s. Twenty-four prefixes use the same nuisance-projected solver policy after local coordinates become identifiable.

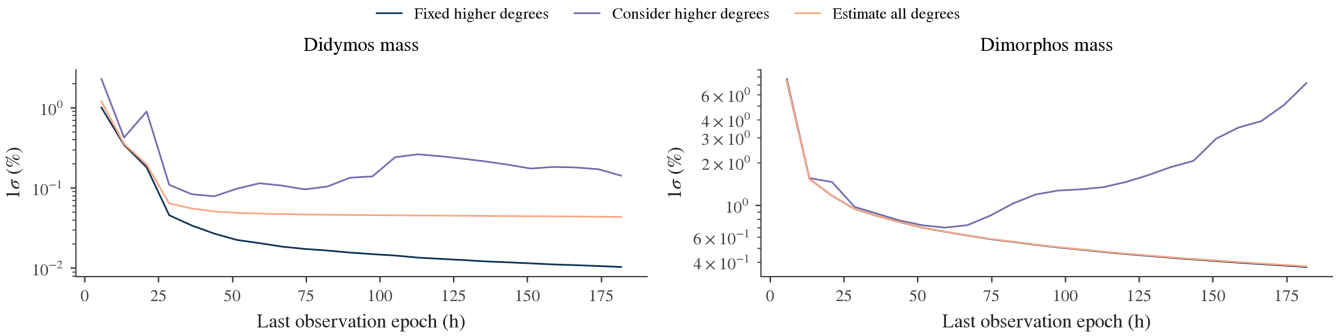
Three experiments share the same nominal dynamics and measurement rows:

Higher-degree treatment	Estimated coordinates	Degree-3/4 uncertainty
Fixed	32: initial state, barycenter nuisance, both masses and degree-2 moments	Zero; 50 higher-degree moments held exact
Considered	The same 32	Correlated external covariance from the paper's higher-degree harmonic and independent raw-moment prior equations
Coestimated	All 82	All moments fitted with the original paper priors

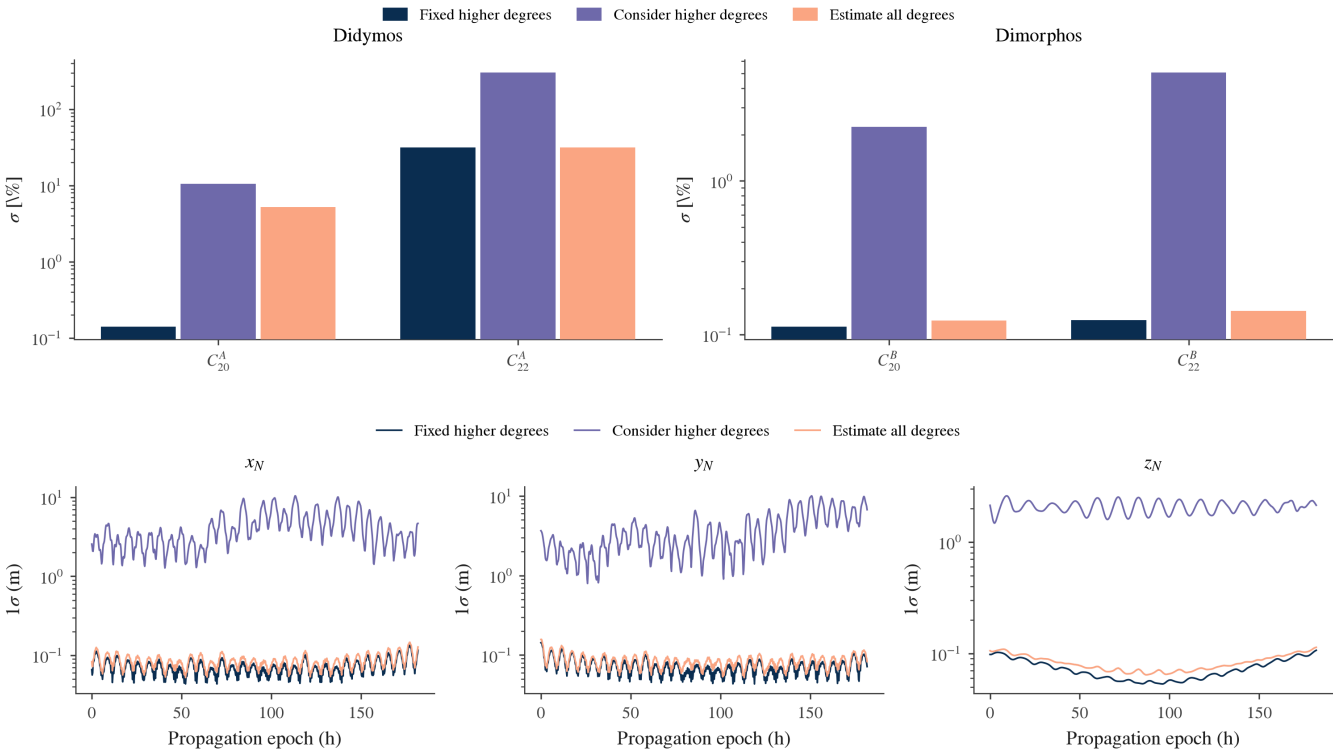
The fixed and considered estimators keep only degree-2 prior information. Their external higher-degree distribution is not also fitted as a prior. The considered case is fixed-estimator analysis; it does not reweight observations using that uncertainty.

Final default AD mass standard deviations:

Higher-degree treatment	Didymos, % of mass	Dimorphos, % of mass
Fixed	0.0103133	0.369268
Considered	0.141883	7.22531
Coestimated	0.0434185	0.373392



The growing considered uncertainty is an estimator-sensitivity effect. The external distribution is unchanged at every cutoff. Fixing the higher field exactly understates the error of an estimator exposed to the declared uncertain higher field. Coestimating it lets the measurements constrain those directions.



The last figure maps one all-data result over physical epochs. Component sigmas span approximately 0.0433–0.1443 m (fixed), 0.795–10.446 m (considered), and 0.0520–0.1577 m (coestimated). These describe the **binary relative orbit**, not a CubeSat descent or landing footprint.

Both the fresh default AD and identity-checked native runs reproduce all nine printed AC3 Table 2 entries in the coestimated case. Their new mass histories agree to at worst 1.20e-4 relative sigma, and position covariance histories to 3.65e-5 relative matrix norm, within the existing 1e-3 long-chaotic-Hera acceptance. The final full suite passes 396 tests with AD/plotting; native and AD reference snapshots remain bitwise unchanged. See complete acceptance and reproducibility commands.

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --plot examples/hera_uncertainty.py \
  --output "$PWD/results/hera-uncertainty"
```

`--native` selects a fresh native propagation. `--reuse-native PATH` reuses a completed checked native BASCO transport. `--reuse-transport PATH` reuses a completed transport matching the selected provider. Use a new output folder; the runner checkpoints transport before analysis and refuses to overwrite existing artifacts. Each descriptive case folder contains the standard study export plus `mass-history/` and `relative-position-history/`; shared figures are in `figures/`. The rendering tool regenerates the figure recipe from verified exports without solving again.

References and limits

BASCO's batch consider formulation is documented against Hinks and Psiaki, A Multipurpose Consider Covariance Analysis for Square-Root Information Filters and the inspected SCARABAEUS batch implementation. The latter maps final batch covariance to epochs; BASCO separately exposes observation-prefix

histories. NASA Navigation Filter Best Practices describes consider filtering and cross-covariance principles; BASCO's current batch analysis does not claim that recursive algorithm.

The equation contract and research record records the inspected revision, assumptions, retrieval date and independent validation requirements. Sequential filters, process noise and independent multi-arc prefix histories remain separate work. The next application is described in CubeSat descent and landing covariance.

Multi-arc covariance and estimation

Multi-arc analysis estimates shared physical quantities from several locally parameterized trajectories. Masses and gravity can be common while each arc retains its own initial state and observation nuisance. BASCO supports both a convenient continuous-nominal timeline and direct assembly of independent arc linearizations.

Continuous nominal trajectory and independent arc states

This fragment assumes `model`, `parameters`, `channels` and `bc` from your study. Include `.estimate_initial_state()` in `parameters` when arc-start binary states are to be coestimated:

```
plan = bc.ObservationPlan.uniform(
    stop=14 * 86400.0,
    cadence=900.0,
    channels=channels,
    schedule=bc.PeriodicBlackout(period=86400.0, duration=8 * 3600.0),
)
timeline = bc.ArcTimeline.every(3.5 * 86400.0, stop=14 * 86400.0)
campaign = bc.MultiArcCovarianceStudy(
    model,
    parameters,
    plan,
    timeline,
    integrator=bc.RK4(dt=75.0),
)
multi = campaign.linearize()
result = multi.covariance()
print(result.summary())
print(campaign.arc_summary(multi))
```

ArcTimeline cuts contiguous mission intervals starting at zero. `every(...)` creates equal lengths and a shorter final remainder when needed; `from_bounds(...)` accepts explicit bounds/names. Arc lengths must be compatible with the plan cadence and the integration grid. A boundary observation belongs to the arc ending there.

MultiArcCovarianceStudy propagates each arc from the preceding nominal end state, with an explicit SO(3) projection at the restart. Schedules evaluate mission time, so daily gaps remain daily across boundaries. It defaults to Hou AD; pass `transport=bc.NativeAnalyticTransport()` for manual derivatives.

Nominal continuity does **not** impose estimation continuity constraints. Local state errors remain independently parameterized; no process noise or sequential-filter assumption is introduced.

Reusing arc propagation

```
retained = campaign.transports(multi)
```

Construct another campaign with the same physics, timeline, state treatment and output grid but different observation schedules/channels, then call:

```
changed_multi = changed_campaign.linearize(transports=retained)
changed_result = changed_multi.covariance()
```

Here `changed_campaign` is the newly configured `MultiArcCovarianceStudy`. Each named arc's transport is checked. Noise/prior changes on `multi` require neither this reassembly nor propagation.

The multi-arc example compares a single arc, gaps and independent arcs, then sweeps blackout duration with retained transport.

Assemble independent linearized studies directly

When arcs have independently supplied start states, build each ordinary study first. For `early_rows` and `late_rows` returned by those studies:

```
multi = bc.MultiArcStudy(
    {
        "early": early_rows.with_priors(()),
        "late": late_rows.with_priors(()),
    },
    priors=shared_priors,
    solver=bc.NuisanceProjectedSolver(),
)
result = multi.covariance()
```

`shared_priors` is the tuple of global prior producers you intend to apply once. Using `with_priors(())` avoids carrying a shared prior separately from each arc. Genuine local priors may remain on their arcs; any arc prior touching a shared parameter is rejected to prevent double counting.

By default every physical parameter ID must agree between arcs and is shared. Explicit `shared_parameters=("primary.mass", ...)` shares a subset; other physical coordinates become local. Shared nominal values, units and physical meaning must match. Local labels become `arc.early.<source-label>` and `arc.late.<source-label>`; shared IDs retain their names.

`multi.arc_columns(name)` maps a source arc's coordinate order into global columns. The full supported covariance retains cross-arc and local/shared cross blocks. A complete common physical report needs a complete shared physical map; partial sharing may require named covariance blocks or a custom derived transform.

Noise across arcs

Independent per-arc noise is the default. Pass a mapping such as `noise={"early": early_noise, "late": late_noise}` to replace weights per arc. A single full correlated model can represent cross-arc observation correlation, following the assembled scalar row order.

Shared prior knowledge enters once globally. Global correlated priors can also use fully qualified local coordinate IDs when the statistical model actually connects those local quantities.

Solve a frozen-linear correction

```
fit = multi.estimate({
    "early": observed_minus_predicted_early,
    "late": observed_minus_predicted_late,
})
print(fit.corrections_for(("primary.mass", "secondary.mass")))
print(fit.covariance.summary())
```

The two vectors are externally supplied **observed minus nominal prediction** residuals, in the exact source arc row order and physical units. This is one weighted linear correction at a fixed nominal, including prior mean-minus-reference residuals. It is not a nonlinear mission-data fit.

MultiArcEstimate retains corrections, covariance, postfit residuals and diagnostics. A deficient solve identifies supported combinations and records its minimum-scaled-norm convention for unresolved correction components; unresolved values are not thereby physically determined.

Nonlinear batch/MAP callbacks

MultiArcBatchEstimator supplies a generic relinearizing Gauss–Newton driver with actual-objective backtracking:

```
solution = bc.MultiArcBatchEstimator(
    max_iterations=15,
    step_rtol=1e-9,
    gradient_rtol=1e-9,
).solve(
    initial_guess,
    linearize=build_arcs_and_residuals,
    retract=apply_named_correction,
)
print(solution.converged, solution.status)
```

This is an interface fragment: you must implement both callbacks for your application. `build_arcs_and_residuals(state)` returns `(MultiArcStudy, residual_mapping)` at that nominal. It rebuilds predictions, rows and prior references while keeping observations, noise and prior means fixed.

`apply_named_correction(state, correction, layout)` returns a new state consistent with the rows' named differential. It owns finite attitude retraction and positive-mass handling. Neither callback may mutate its input.

Convergence, exhausted iterations, rank deficiency and failed line search remain distinct statuses. Returned covariance belongs to the returned statistical nominal; backtracking adds no fictitious information.

Current limitations

Generic nonlinear numerical tests exist. Complete binary observed-value ingestion, measured-attitude residual adapters and seeded mission-style recovery are unfinished. Sequential filters/process noise are planned, not implemented interchangeable filter choices. Do not describe a covariance reproduction or a callback API as a validated real Hera-data fit.

The multi-arc design and schedule/arc evidence record the tested semantics and limitations.

Results and exports

Read uncertainty availability before reading its numerical value. BASCO separates quantities supported by the experiment, quantities fixed by configuration and unresolved directions. Tables, plots and exports all consume the same shared presentation dataset so those distinctions remain consistent.

Consider results and covariance histories add held uncertain parameters, observation-prefix uncertainty and fixed-information physical output maps. History exports preserve full within-epoch output covariance, source Jacobians and the meaning of their time axis.

Snippets use the `rows` and `result` produced by the quickstart.

Result summaries

```
print(result.summary())
print(result.mass_properties().summary())
print(result.degree2().summary())
print(result.harmonics(max_degree=4).summary())
```

CovarianceResult retains data rank, posterior rank, marginal physical rank, singular values, thresholds, nullspace and diagnostics. Priors may make a posterior supported without making its data-only counterpart observable.

Report	Contents and convention
`mass_properties()`	Individual and total mass, fixed-G individual/total GM, secondary/primary mass ratio
`degree2()`	Normalized moments, unnormalized C20/C22 and dimensional Izz
`harmonics(max_degree=4)`	Unnormalized exterior C/S at the model's declared fixed reference radii

DerivedReport holds labels, values, units, Jacobian, covariance, row statuses, conventions and `sigma`. A fixed quantity with zero error is distinct from a measured quantity with high precision. A zero nominal coefficient can have a meaningful absolute sigma but has no defined relative percentage uncertainty.

Cross covariance

Mass sum, mass ratio and gravity transforms need the relevant off-diagonal terms. Do not combine individual sigma values as if independent unless independence is part of the actual covariance.

```
if result.full_rank:
    labels = ("primary.mass", "secondary.mass")
    mass_covariance = result.covariance_for(labels)
    mass_correlation = result.correlation_for(labels)
```

These named methods preserve the requested order and return protected copies. `parameter_covariance` is the physical-parameter block; `state_parameter_covariance` retains the local-state/nuisance to physical-parameter cross block when available.

For a deficient joint solution, `joint_covariance` is unavailable. `supported_subspace_covariance` is only valid for functions that annihilate the reported nullspace. It is not a finite full covariance for arbitrary unresolved coordinates.

Custom derived quantities

This fragment computes total mass from the full named coordinate layout, using the same nullspace-aware transform as built-in reports:

```
labels = rows.layout.labels
jacobian = np.zeros((1, len(labels)))
jacobian[0, labels.index("primary.mass")] = 1.0
jacobian[0, labels.index("secondary.mass")] = 1.0
total = result.derived(
    labels=("custom.total_mass",),
    values=[study.model.system.primary.mass + study.model.system.secondary.mass],
    units=("kg",),
    jacobian=jacobian,
    conventions={"definition": "primary.mass + secondary.mass"},
)
print(total.summary())
```

It assumes both masses were selected and NumPy is imported. Normally use `mass_properties()` for this quantity; the example shows the public custom-transform boundary. The Jacobian columns must match the entire joint layout, including local columns.

Run exports

```
folder = bc.export_study(
    rows,
    result,
    root=Path(__file__).resolve().parent / "results",
    label="my-binary-g06-e04",
    reports={
        "mass": result.mass_properties(),
        "harmonics": result.harmonics(4),
    },
    figures=True,
    theme=bc.PlotTheme(tex=False),
)
```

This needs `Path` from `pathlib` and the plotting environment. Omit `figures=True` for a numeric/table-only run. The standard folder name includes a readable label, UTC timestamp and scientific analysis digest.

```
my-binary-g06-e04__UTC-TIMESTAMP__DIGEST/
  README.md
  configuration.json
  run.json
  manifest.json
  reports/
    report.md
    report.json
    tables/
    figures/
    manifest.json
  arrays/
    metadata.json
    *.npy
  validation/
    README.md
```

`configuration.json` stores configuration. `run.json` names matrix axes, layouts, units, identities, diagnostics and prior provenance. Plan sigmas are retained separately from the actual analysis weighting. Numeric arrays include states, sensitivities, rows, scales, covariance when available and the rank spectrum/nullspace.

Files are staged, checksummed and published together. Existing destinations are refused. Export does not automatically launch derivative checks: the validation directory states what is known, and checks remain explicitly requested.

The analysis digest retains scientific/statistical choices and scales but excludes elapsed runtime. Creation time remains in folder names/metadata; timing remains available for operational evidence.

Reading saved results

```
arrays, presentation, run = bc.read_run(folder)
H = arrays["design_rows_SI"]
print(run["metadata"]["layouts"]["joint_coordinate"]["labels"])
bc.write_presentation(
    presentation,
    "restyled-results",
    figures=True,
    theme=bc.PlotTheme(tex=False, width=10.0, font_size=11.0, dpi=300),
)
```

read_run verifies checksums and returns data, not a reconstructed live study. read_presentation reloads just a presentation report. A damaged manifest, incomplete run or escaping manifest path is an error.

For standalone numeric/string evidence, write_artifact and read_artifact provide verified JSON/NPY folders. Object arrays and pickle are refused. Each array needs meaningful names and accompanying axis/unit metadata supplied by the producer.

Plot settings

PlotTheme sets figure width, resolution, typography, mathematical text, optional grids and export formats. Its defaults follow the Hera paper's plotting source: 9.5-point STIX typography, 300 dpi, a navy–purple–orange colormap and no grid. Set `grid=True` for a figure that requires grid lines. Rendering uses a local Matplotlib context.

`tex=False` works with built-in mathematical text. `tex=True` requires a functioning external LaTeX installation. Share one theme across figures in a study for consistent labels and visual scale.

Grouped comparison bars

Use saved case reports, not copied sigma arrays or hardcoded coefficient indices:

```
from basco.plotting import uncertainty_comparison_plot

changed = rows.covariance(noise=bc.DiagonalNoise(2.0 * rows.sigmas))
cases = {
    "Baseline": bc.make_presentation(
        result, reports={"mass": result.mass_properties()},
    ),
    "Twice the measurement noise": bc.make_presentation(
        changed, reports={"mass": changed.mass_properties()},
    ),
}
comparison = uncertainty_comparison_plot(
    cases,
    table="mass",
    metric="relative_percent",
    labels=("primary.mass", "secondary.mass"),
    identifier="mass_noise_trade",
    title="Individual mass uncertainty",
)
bc.write_presentation(
    cases["Baseline"],
    "mass-noise-comparison",
    figures=True,
    plots=(comparison,),
    theme=bc.PlotTheme(tex=False),
)
```

Available metrics are `"sigma"`, `"relative_percent"` and `"gain"`; gain requires an explicit reference presentation. Report IDs, quantity units and conventions must be compatible. Unsupported quantities stay visibly unavailable.

Bar layout

BarLayout controls figure dimensions, panel arrangement, bar grouping, colors, optional hatches, tick labels and legend placement independently of the computed data. Dimensions are in inches. The default uses plain bars; hatches are added only when explicitly supplied.

This continues the comparison above. It changes the figure arrangement without repeating propagation or covariance computation:

```
layout = bc.BarLayout(
    group_by="case",
    figsize=(7.6, 3.4),
    legend="first_panel",
    legend_location="upper right",
    legend_columns=1,
    show_titles=False,
)
by_case = uncertainty_comparison_plot(
    cases,
    table="mass",
    metric="relative_percent",
    labels=("primary.mass", "secondary.mass"),
    parameter_labels={
        "primary.mass": r"$\sigma(M_A)$",
        "secondary.mass": r"$\sigma(M_B)$",
    },
    identifier="mass_noise_by_case",
    layout=layout,
)
bc.write_presentation(
    cases["Baseline"],
    "mass-noise-by-case",
    figures=True,
    plots=(by_case,),
    theme=bc.PlotTheme(tex=False),
)
```

`group_by="parameter"` places parameters on the horizontal axis and cases in the legend. `group_by="case"` exchanges those roles. `panel_columns=2` places two body panels side by side. `legend="first_panel"` places the legend inside the first axes; `legend="figure"` uses a shared figure legend. `gain_baseline` changes only the drawn baseline of gain bars; it does not change any reported ratio.

Hera figure layouts

The Hera plotting module defines reusable layouts through the same generic comparison function:

Function	Arrangement and required data
gain_plot	Figure 4: two body panels, gravity/inertia quantities on the horizontal axis and rotational cases in the legend. Requires posterior cases and the stated prior reference in matching conventions.
degree_prior_plot	Figure 5: analysis cases on the horizontal axis and eight gravity, inertia and mass quantities in the legend.
mass_plot	Additional mass-uncertainty figure for the individual masses and their correlated total. This figure supplements the paper.

The caller supplies the computed presentation datasets. These helpers select labels and visual settings; they do not construct priors, run dynamics or alter uncertainties. The Hera example supplies the paper's scientific settings.

For a new figure, PlotDefinition supplies a named `draw(dataset, theme)` callback returning a Matplotlib figure or `None`, plus a caption. Pass it through the same writer. See extensions and the filesystem contract.

Model comparisons

Propagation is usually the expensive part. Retain a LinearizedStudy and its Transport so changes to the statistical question do not accidentally rerun the dynamics. Identity checks reject reuse when physical inputs or numerical policies no longer match.

The fragments below assume `study`, `rows`, `result` and `bc` from the quickstart.

Reweight or change priors

```
data_only = rows.covariance(priors=())
less_precise = rows.covariance(noise=bc.DiagonalNoise(2.0 * rows.sigmas))
joint = rows.covariance(solver=bc.SquareRootSolver())
```

Each call uses the retained unweighted physical rows and performs **zero new dynamics evaluations**. To replace priors, pass the intended complete producer set with `priors=(...)`. Replacing the solver can change the declared support policy, so retain its diagnostics in comparisons.

Reduced parameter sets

For source rows containing masses, degree-2 moments, degree-3/4 harmonics and initial-state errors:

```
degree2_parameters = (
    bc.Parameters(rows.parameters.model)
    .estimate_masses()
    .estimate_moments(degrees=(2,))
    .estimate_initial_state()
)
degree2_rows = rows.with_parameters(degree2_parameters, priors=())
degree2_result = degree2_rows.covariance()
```

The original nominal gravity remains order 6. The dropped higher-degree quantities are **fixed at their nominal values**. This is conditioning; marginalization would instead retain their uncertainty and correlations in the solve. Local observation nuisance remains free.

The subset must use the same nominal model, physical directions and initial-state treatment. Reordering compatible existing columns is allowed; adding directions or changing the raw/harmonic map is not an arbitrary view operation. Priors reset intentionally, because an old prior may not define the new statistical problem.

Change channels on retained epochs

```
position_plan = bc.ObservationPlan.uniform(
    stop=study.observations.duration,
    cadence=study.observations.cadence,
    channels=(bc.RelativePosition(sigma=1.0),),
)
position_study = bc.CovarianceStudy(
    study.model,
    study.parameters,
    position_plan,
    integrator=study.integrator,
)
position_rows = position_study.linearize(transport=rows.transport)
position_result = position_rows.covariance()
```

This reassembles observation rows from compatible retained transport. A blackout or per-stream schedule on the same grid can follow the same route. There are no ODE evaluations during the reassembly, but the channels' value/partial maps still evaluate.

If the source study explicitly used native transport, the new study must also specify `transport=bc.NativeAnalyticTransport()`. Defaults are AD; provider identity is checked rather than silently relabeling native arrays as AD.

Changing mutual gravity order

Order-4 and order-6 dynamics are different forward models and require separate propagation. For each, construct a `BinaryDynamics` using the same declared system/state and its intended `HouGravity(mutual_order=...)`, then build its own `Parameters` attached to that model.

Hold duration, integration accuracy, observations, priors, parameter meaning and reporting conventions fixed when the goal is to isolate force-model order. A degree-4 estimate under order-4 versus order-6 gravity is a valid pair of model-conditioned covariance studies. The difference between their sigmas is not a direct estimate of truncation bias.

The Hera degree-trade runner separates fresh `propagate` runs from zero-dynamics `compare` runs. Its explicit `--derivatives ad|native` option keeps retained-provider identity clear. The validated degree trades explain the paper and alternative experiments.

Recomputation requirements

Changed input	Reuse retained rows?	Reuse existing transport?
Noise, priors, covariance solver or threshold	Yes	Already retained

Changed input	Reuse retained rows?	Reuse existing transport?
Compatible subset/reordering of existing estimated parameters	`with_parameters(...)`	Already retained
Channels, sigma defaults or mask on same grid	Reassemble rows	Yes, if identity matches
Gravity order, body moments/masses or initial state	No	No
Integrator step/policy or derivative provider	No	No
New required epochs or new physical directions	No arbitrary reuse	Requires appropriate compatible transport

The transport identity includes physical data, coordinate maps, initial state, epochs, provider and integration policy. The linearization identity also captures row assembly. The final analysis identity adds weighting, priors, scales and numerical support choices while excluding wall-clock timings.

Comparison records

For each case, export the computed result, its configuration and provenance. Mark whether it was fresh propagation, archived-row replay or new analysis of retained BASCO transport. Then use comparison bar charts to ensure labels, conventions and uncertainty statuses are checked across cases.

The reuse example is a small runnable starting point. For independent arcs, multi-arc reuse retains one checked transport per named arc.

Hera paper reproduction

The Hera study is BASCO's main scientific example. It estimates **both masses and gravity-related moments through degree 4**, propagating the nominal binary with **Hou mutual gravity order 6**. Four rotational states reproduce every one of the paper's **36 printed Table 2 percentages**. This chapter gives the runnable entry points, the scientific choices behind them, and what the reproduction establishes.

Start with installation and your first run if the managed environments are not built. The examples gallery offers smaller demonstrations before committing to full propagation.

Run one case or all four

Run these commands from the repository root after the managed build:

```
# Full tumbling, tables and publication-style figures.
python3 -B tools/dev.py hera

# All four paper cases; independent processes; tables and numeric exports.
python3 -B tools/dev.py hera_cases

# Select cases and control concurrency.
python3 -B tools/dev.py hera_cases AC1 AC3 --jobs 2

# Add figures to the four-case runner in the plotting environment.
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --plot examples/hera_all_cases.py --figures
```

The one-case runner is examples/hera_covariance.py. The four-case runner is examples/hera_all_cases.py. Both compose ordinary library components; neither contains a second covariance engine.

Full cases cost minutes with AD on the measured Mac; historical native runs took about 25 minutes per case. Phase 2's four AD cases each took 199–201 seconds while other validation shared the host. Compilation, CPU, workload and scientific choices affect timing. The four-case runner supports `--jobs 1` to reduce simultaneous resource use. It does not make a short run a paper reproduction: Table 2 requires the full 16 orbits and the stated settings.

`hera` requests external LaTeX through `PlotTheme(tex=True)`. It needs both the plotting dependencies and a working TeX installation. The four-case runner uses the theme's default math rendering unless changed. See results and plotting.

Model and numerical settings

Choice	Paper reproduction
Primary	Didymos DART SPC v003 polyhedral moments, complete through degree 6
Secondary	Uniform ellipsoid, semiaxes 96, 74 and 59 m, complete through degree 6
Masses	Didymos 525,852,763,514.02 kg; Dimorphos 4,539,936,844.07 kg
Fixed gravitational constant	`6.674e-11` $m^3\ kg^{-1}\ s^{-2}$
Fixed reference radii	367.8508020568785 m and 74.83733635110467 m
Mutual gravity cutoff	Hou total order 6
Independent physical estimated parameters	Both masses; 28 mass-normalized raw moments per body: 3 degree-2 diagonal terms, 10 degree-3 terms, 15 degree-4 terms
Local coordinates	18 initial-state errors; 3 barycenter offsets and 3 barycenter rates
Total unknowns	58 physical + 18 initial state + 6 barycenter = **82**
Duration	16 × 11.3674 h = 654,762.24 s
Integration	Fixed-step RK4, 75 s
Measurement epochs	727 positive epochs at 900 s cadence; no epoch-zero observation
Scalar design rows	12 per epoch, **8,724** in total
Posterior prior	36 harmonic rows plus 56 independent raw-moment rows
Unconstrained by that prior	Both masses, all initial-state errors, all barycenter coordinates
Numerical solver	`NuisanceProjectedSolver`
Current default derivative route	Hou automatic differentiation; native analytic is explicit and preserved

The radii are the fixed bounding-ellipsoid volume radii used in the manuscript. Substituting a mesh-volume radius changes harmonic normalization. The nominal moments, gravity cutoff, uncertain coordinates and output normalization are independent choices; parameters explains why.

`hera.load_inputs` reads checksum-verified BASCO-owned inputs from reference/hera-20261016. The original PyGUBAS and Gravity Inertia directories are not runtime dependencies. The benchmark's preprocessing and state construction live in basco.benchmarks.hera.

Rotational cases

Case	Name	Initial secondary libration	Wobble	Orbit and excitation
AC0	Equilibrium	0°	0°	Circular, planar, synchronous; retained order-6 speed calibration
AC1	Libration only	10°	0°	Eccentricity 0.0274; primary inclination 1°; secondary obliquity 3°
AC2	Limited tumbling	10°	20°	Same excited orbit as AC1
AC3	Full tumbling	90°	43.09°	Same excited orbit as AC1

The initial-condition helper retains the source full-field period/separation solve and the source spin conventions. The secondary's excited-case spin uses the pre-impact 11.921493 h period. Changing the active gravity order keeps these order-6-calibrated initial conditions unchanged. It does not silently refit an orbit.

Runner configuration

This complete composition is the paper's default study, using the public components. `ROOT` below is the absolute BASCO checkout path; when writing a script inside `examples/`, use `Path(__file__).resolve().parents[1]` instead of hard-coding it.

```python
from pathlib import Path

import numpy as np
import basco as bc
from basco.benchmarks import hera

ROOT = Path("/absolute/path/to/BASCO")
REFERENCE = ROOT / "reference" / "hera-20261016"

# 1. Nominal bodies, rigid-body state and active Hou gravity order.
inputs = hera.load_inputs(REFERENCE)
model = hera.build_hera_model(inputs, "AC3", gravity_degree=6)

# 2. Uncertain physical coordinates and the initial-state tangent.
parameters = (
    bc.Parameters(model)
    .estimate_masses()
    .estimate_moments(degrees=(2, 3, 4))
    .estimate_initial_state()
)

# 3. Measurement streams and independently estimated barycenter.
observations = bc.ObservationPlan.uniform(
    stop=hera.DURATION_S,
    cadence=900.0,
    channels=(
        bc.RelativePosition(sigma=1.0),
        bc.BodyAttitude("secondary", sigma=np.deg2rad(1.0)),
        bc.BodyAttitude("primary", sigma=np.deg2rad(1.0)),
        bc.PrimaryBarycentricPosition(
            sigma=1.0,
            nuisance=bc.PolynomialBias("barycenter", degree=1),
        ),
    ),
)

# 4. Prior knowledge, integration and numerical support policy.
study = bc.CovarianceStudy(
    model,
    parameters,
    observations,
    integrator=bc.RK4(dt=75.0),
    priors=(hera.HeraKaulaPrior(parameters, REFERENCE),),
    solver=bc.NuisanceProjectedSolver(),
)

# 5. Propagate once, analyze, then present without new dynamics.
rows = study.linearize()
result = rows.covariance()
paper = hera.hera_report(result)
print(paper.summary())

folder = bc.export_study(
    rows,
    result,
    ROOT / "results",
    label="hera-full-tumbling-g06-e04",
    reports={
        "paper": paper,
        "harmonics": result.harmonics(),
        "mass": result.mass_properties(),
    },
    figures=True,
    theme=bc.PlotTheme(tex=False),
```

```
)
print(folder)
```

Each numbered part has one owner. BinaryDynamics describes the physics; Parameters selects independent uncertainty coordinates; ObservationPlan describes the measurements; HeraKaulaPrior produces ordinary prior rows; NuisanceProjectedSolver owns numerical elimination; export_study owns standardized output. The derivative provider is another component: add `transport=bc.NativeAnalyticTransport()` to the study for native analytic partials, keeping everything else identical.

The factory `make_study` in the actual runner exposes `state`, `gravity_degree`, `estimate_degrees`, `parameterization`, `higher_degree_bodies`, `prior`, `dt`, `duration` and `transport`. It is an example function, not a hidden global setting or a second public package API.

Didymos barycentric position measurement

The final paper includes Didymos' position relative to the system center of mass. Its model is

$$\boldsymbol{y}_A(t) = -\frac{M_B}{M_A + M_B}\, C_{NA}(t)\boldsymbol{r}_A(t) + \boldsymbol{R}_0 + (t - t_{\mathrm{ref}})\boldsymbol{V}_0.$$

PrimaryBarycentricPosition includes the direct mass-ratio derivative **and** the mass dependence carried through the trajectory. The PolynomialBias adds the six free position/rate coordinates. Dropping this channel changes the experiment. Keeping the channel but dropping its nuisance model assumes a known barycenter and also changes the experiment.

The four streams contribute three scalar components each: inertial relative position, secondary attitude tangent, primary attitude tangent, and primary barycentric position. Position noise is 1 m per component; attitude noise is 1° per component, expressed internally in radians. These attitude directions support formal covariance; general measured-attitude residual ingestion remains separate work.

Kaula prior constraints

The paper configuration combines two **independent** information components: 36 harmonic rows and 56 raw-moment rows. It does not add a mass prior. HeraKaulaPrior binds the reusable KaulaPrior and archived, checksum-verified laws to the selected layout.

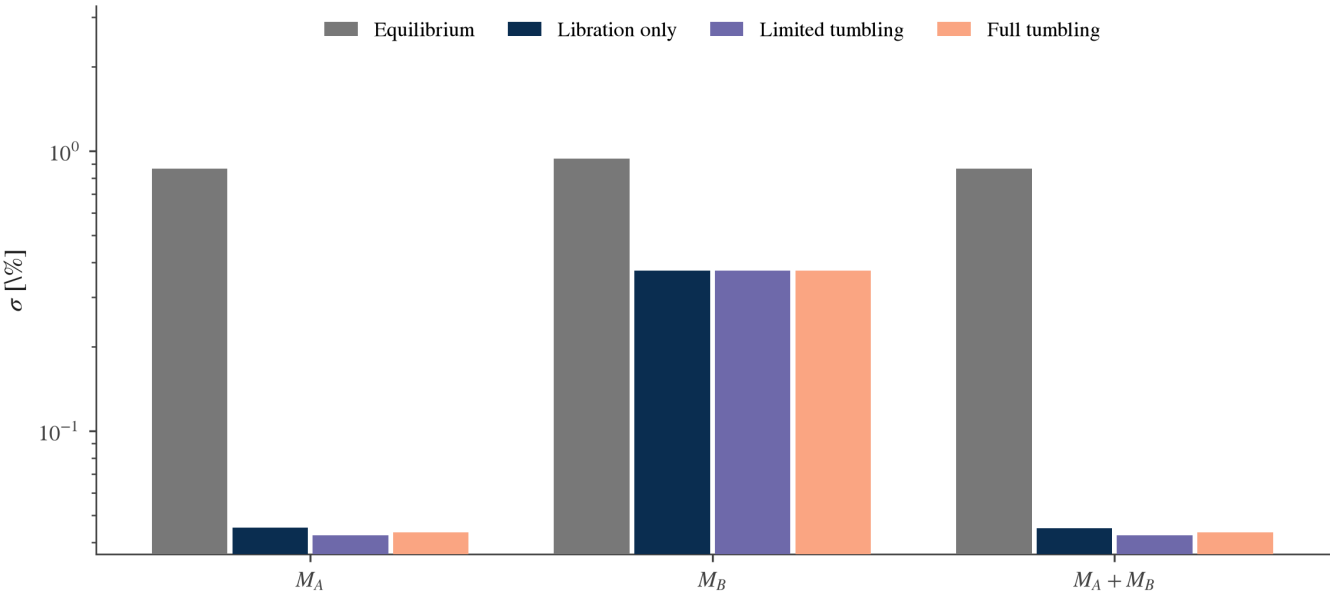
The paper's plotted harmonic prior uncertainty is the original Kaula envelope. The normalized polar-moment prior is taken from the captured round-20 prior record, in units of Izz/(M R²). These are distinct reported quantities. Figure 3 comes from refitting the archived coefficient clouds; it does not imply that every original random mesh was regenerated. See shapes and Kaula for newly sampled ensembles.

Table 2: all printed percentages

Every entry is formal `100 × sigma / abs(nominal)` in percent. The paper's `Izz` means the dimensionless `Izz/(M R²)`. hera_report also handles the paper's 4π geodesy-normalized harmonics; the general `result.degree2()` report uses unnormalized degree-2 coefficients and dimensional inertia. Compare the same conventions.

Formal 1σ [%]	Equilibrium	Libration only	Limited tumbling	Full tumbling
Didymos C20	51.9	5.29	5.00	5.20
Didymos C22	30.5	31.4	31.5	31.5
Didymos C30	13.7	13.4	13.3	13.4
Didymos Izz/(M R²)	18.0	16.9	16.9	16.9
Didymos mass	0.862	0.0451	0.0424	0.0434
Dimorphos C20	29.3	0.502	0.336	0.123
Dimorphos C22	23.8	0.955	0.513	0.143
Dimorphos Izz/(M R²)	21.5	0.449	0.288	0.119
Dimorphos mass	0.940	0.374	0.374	0.373

Download the published Table 2 CSV. The four-case runner prints the cases side by side and marks any value outside the manuscript's printed rounding interval.



These are formal uncertainties for Didymos, Dimorphos and their correlated total mass. The mass plot supplements the paper's Table 2.

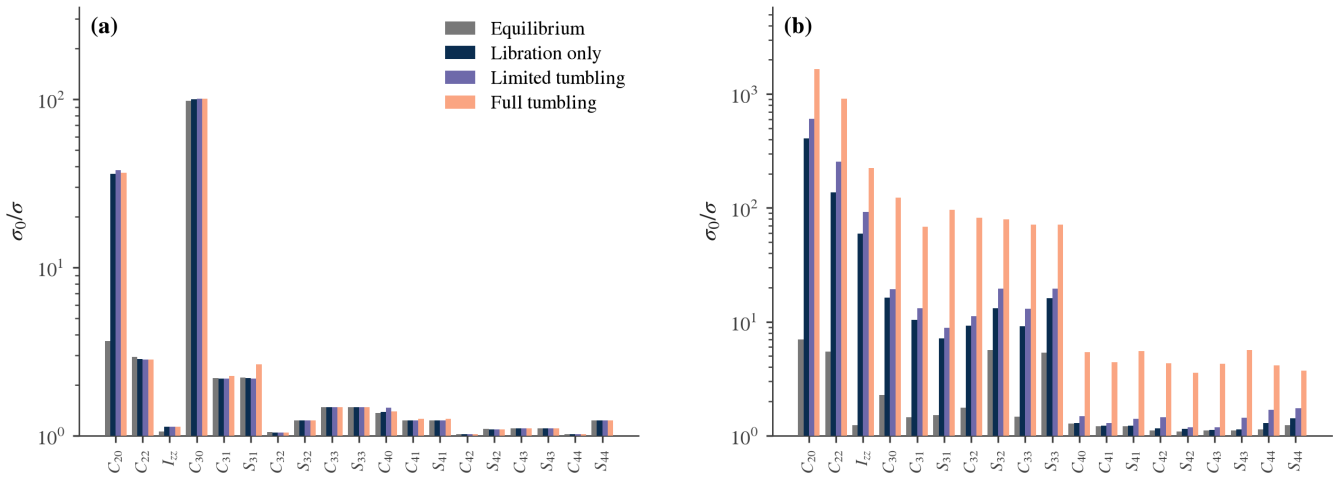


Figure 4 layout: Didymos (a), Dimorphos (b); four rotational cases and the normalized polar moment alongside the gravity coefficients. The colors, plain bars, internal legend and panel proportions follow the supplied paper. Figures are rendered from retained validated results.

Degree, prior and gravity trades

Use separate choices rather than changing a kernel:

```
# Inside a script with make_study from examples/hera_covariance.py:
degree2 = make_study("AC3", estimate_degrees=(2,), prior="none")

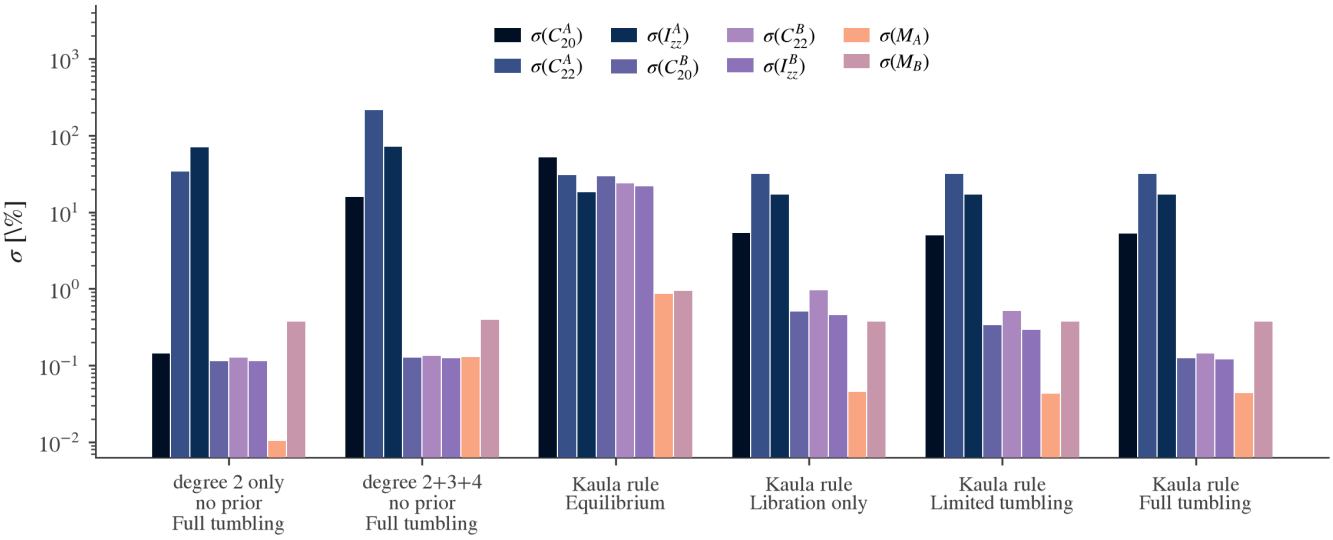
# The paper's expanded no-prior case: primary-only higher harmonics.
primary_high = make_study(
    "AC3",
    estimate_degrees=(2, 3, 4),
    parameterization="harmonics",
    higher_degree_bodies="primary",
    prior="none",
)

paper_baseline = make_study("AC3")
gravity4 = make_study("AC3", gravity_degree=4)
```

The second Figure 5 group estimates both bodies' degree-2 inertia coordinates and masses, plus **primary-only exterior degree-3/4 harmonics**. It is not the same as both-body raw degree-4 moments without a prior. The latter retains structural trace null directions; its unavailable uncertainties must remain unavailable.

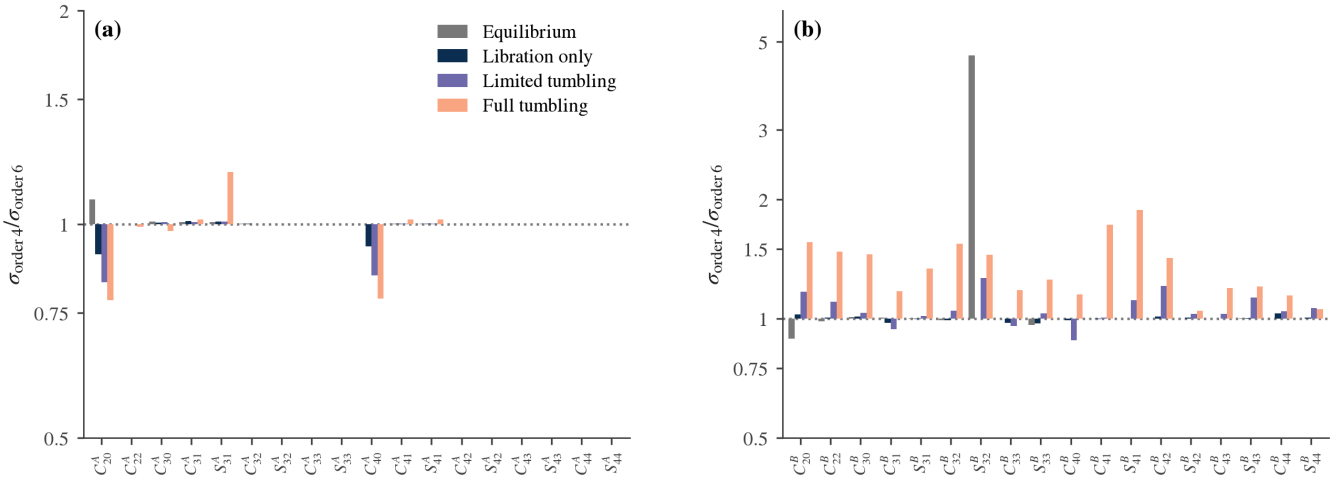
hera_degree_trades.py implements these comparisons. `propagate` makes a new transport; `compare` verifies and remaps completed BASCO transports without more propagation. Retained comparison fixtures are native, so `compare` defaults to `--derivatives native`; fresh `propagate` defaults to AD. A backend identity mismatch is rejected rather than relabeled.

Figure 5's reproduced no-prior sigma errors are 2.5417e-6 for degree 2 and 3.8168e-6 for the primary-only higher-degree experiment. The four prior cases pass the same Table 2 checks. Degree-trade evidence records the exact scientific configuration.



The six groups compare the two no-prior experiments with the four Kaula-prior rotational cases. The legend includes both estimated masses. Izz denotes the normalized polar moment used in the paper's percentage reports.

Changing gravity order requires a new trajectory. Changing only compatible priors/noise can reuse rows. Reducing the uncertain coordinate subset can reuse validated transport through the corresponding map; it conditions omitted estimated parameters as fixed. The workflow chapter explains reuse boundaries.



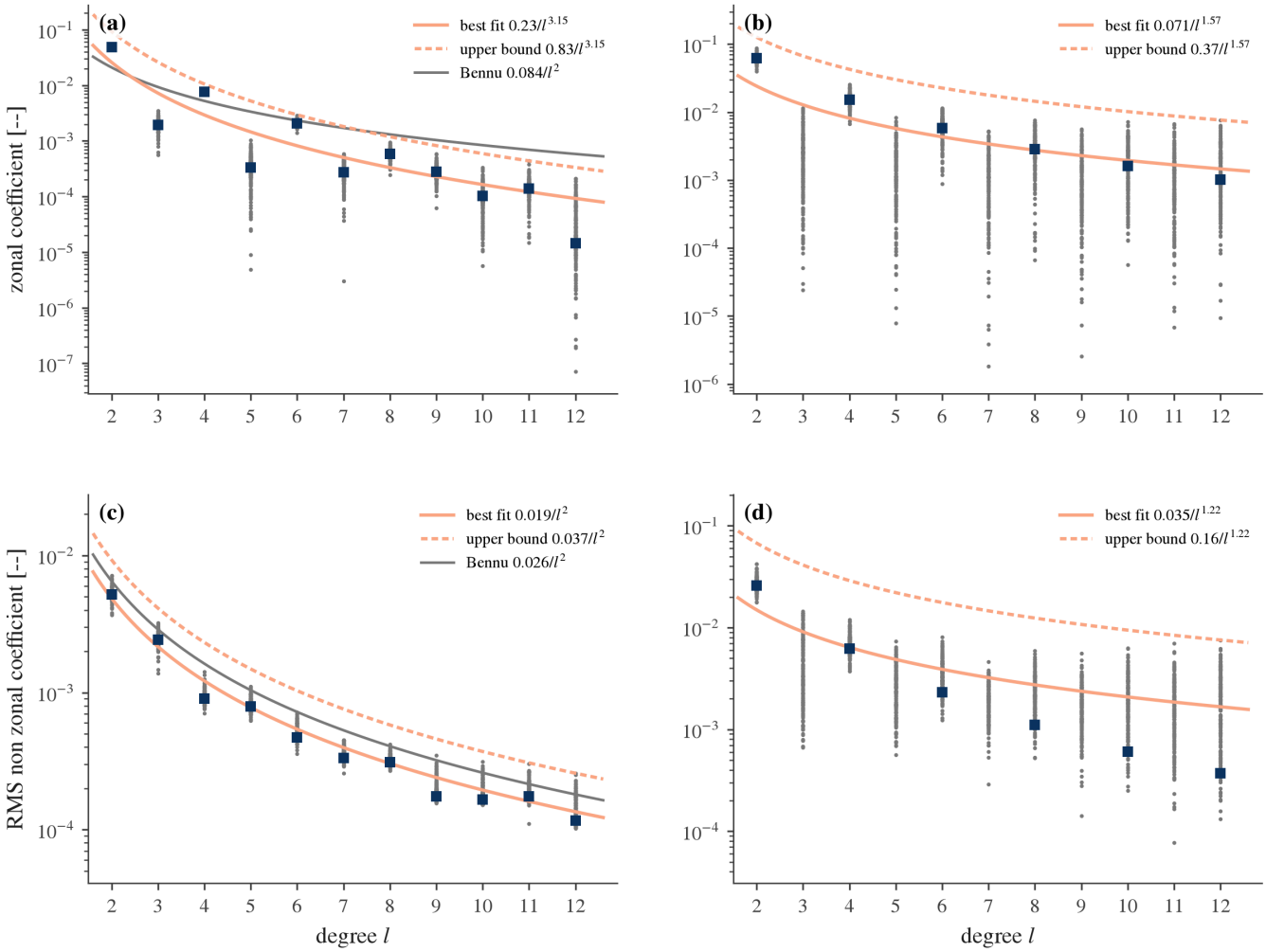
An order-4/order-6 ratio compares two **model-conditioned covariances**. It does not measure parameter bias from omitted gravity or prove that the model with smaller formal errors is more accurate.

Figure 3 and the shape ensembles

```
# Refit both archived clouds; no trajectory propagation or new mesh ensemble.
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --plot examples/hera_kaula.py --tex

# Explicitly sample a small new seeded demonstration instead.
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --plot examples/hera_kaula.py \
  --fresh --max-degree 4 --copies 3 --subdivisions 1
```

The archived fit reproduces the Didymos law exactly and the Dimorphos law to 5.9e-15 maximum relative difference. The ensemble includes 200 shape perturbations plus density variants. Fresh low-resolution sampling is an API demonstration, not a fresh reproduction of the complete paper ensemble.



Didymos occupies the left column and Dimorphos the right. Grey points are the retained perturbed-shape models; navy squares are the nominal constant-density values. Orange solid and dashed curves give the fitted law and adopted upper bound. The Didymos panels also show the Bennu reference law.

Fresh propagation, row replay and saved results

Operation	What it establishes	Additional dynamics
Fresh `CovarianceStudy.linearize()`	BASCO's transport, observation assembly, priors and solver reproduce the configured experiment	Yes
`hera.load_hera_archive(...)`	Archived PyGUBAS rows, transformed into physical SI coordinates, agree under BASCO covariance/report algebra	No

Operation	What it establishes	Additional dynamics
`hera.load_retained_transport(...)`	A checked completed BASCO trajectory supports a compatible new estimated parameter/measurement analysis	No
`read_run(folder)` or presentation rendering	A saved result is checksum-valid and can be read/reformatted	No

Replay converts native kilometers, fractional moment/GM columns and centered Legendre barycenter coefficients into SI mass, moment, `R0` and `V0` coordinates. It is valuable independent evidence of conversions and algebra, but it cannot validate fresh dynamics on its own.

The latest Phase 2 acceptance is **four fresh default-Hou-AD runs**, not replay. All 160 reported sigmas pass the declared 1e-3 relative archive/native criterion, and all 36 printed Table 2 values match their rounding bins:

Case	Maximum relative sigma error vs archive	Vs frozen native
AC0	5.291134e-11	1.160849e-11
AC1	6.788903e-11	3.926393e-11
AC2	2.780115e-10	1.373615e-10
AC3	2.243221e-6	1.457388e-6

The full-tumbling case amplifies long-arc rounding; its small residual difference is recorded, not hidden. Earlier native fresh propagation and archived-row replay are separate checkpoints. Historical replay's maximum relative sigma error was 2.475084e-9 under its stricter 1e-7 criterion.

The latest Phase 2 validation record owns the current acceptance numbers. Frozen compact evidence retains covariance/scales, comparisons, executed source and logs. Earlier reproduction notes explain source capture, conversions and native evidence; statements there about then-unimplemented AD/schedules are historical.

Output files

The one-case export contains the `paper`, `harmonics` and `mass` report families, numeric arrays, layouts/units, configuration/provenance, checksums and optional figures. Standard run names include a descriptive label, UTC timestamp and analysis identity. See results for the full directory contract.

```
saved = bc.read_run(folder)  # Verifies the completed standard run.
print(result.mass_properties().summary())  # Both masses, total, GMs and ratio.
print(hera.hera_report(result).summary())  # Exact paper conventions.
```

Never label a prior/noise/degree variant as the paper baseline without recording its changes. The saved configuration and provider identity are the evidence, not the folder's informal nickname.

Limits of the reproduction

These are formal local uncertainties around a nominal rigid-body model. They do not constitute a fit to actual Hera observations, a nonlinear uncertainty-validity proof over chaotic arcs, or a new integration-step convergence study. Complete end-to-end finite-difference coverage of the covariance chain is still open.

Round 20 supplies Table 2's baseline. Six same-dynamics round-21 prior/noise/baseline variants have been checked; **13 other round-21 trajectory/basis variants remain unverified**. In particular, one archived position-noise sweep holds the barycentric noise fixed while later paper plotting ties it to relative-position noise. Baseline 1 m results coincide; other points need the matching reanalysis.

Continue with multi-arc studies, shapes and Kaula, or the complete capability map.

Example scripts

Every script below is an existing user example in `examples/`. They run against the installed library and compose the same modular components used for custom studies. This gallery documents their real behavior; opening these pages runs no scientific computation.

Script index

Goal	Start here	Fresh dynamics?	Output
Check installation cheaply	So smoke run	One short prefix	Console; optional numeric artifact
Build your own binary	Custom binary	One short prefix	Null-aware console summary
Understand component reuse	Noise/prior/channel reuse	Initial propagation only	Compared summaries
Reproduce the paper	One Hera case	Full 16 orbits	Standard results and figures
Reproduce Table 2	All Hera cases	Four independent full propagations	Table 2 and per-case runs
Check analytic versus AD	Derivative comparison	Both routes	Asserted report agreement
Fit Kaula laws	Kaula and new shapes	No trajectory dynamics	Laws, figures, tables, manifest
Compare degrees/priors	Degree and gravity trades	`propagate`: yes; `compare`: no	Study reports and plots
Assess tracking gaps/arcs	Multi-arc	Continuous and arc transports; sweep reused	Console; optional artifact
Compare fixed, considered and estimated gravity	Hera uncertainty histories	One shared transport	Mass histories, gravity bars and binary-position uncertainty
Explore old model comparisons	Legacy gravity	Several two-orbit runs	Printed comparison

Environment and execution

Quick start explains `bootstrap`, `build`, `ad_environment` and `plot_environment`. Use the managed launcher from the repository root:

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py run examples/custom_binary.py
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --ad examples/ad_covariance.py
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --plot examples/hera_kaula.py
```

Plain `run` and `--ad` select the JAX environment. `--plot` selects JAX plus plotting. `--native` selects the analytic-only environment. **The environment flag does not change the transport selected inside your script.** A script that omits `transport` still requests default AD; without JAX it raises an actionable error. For native-only execution the script must pass `bc.NativeAnalyticTransport()` or expose its own corresponding option.

The launcher changes the working directory to the machine cache. Resolve data relative to `__file__` or pass absolute input/output paths, for example `--output "$PWD/results/my-new-run"`. Existing scripts already resolve their own bundled inputs. Numeric artifact writers refuse an existing target; standard exports create descriptive unique run folders. Add `--tex` only when a working external LaTeX installation is available.

Historical timings below are observations from an Apple M4 Pro, not performance guarantees. AD compilation, active CPU jobs and selected gravity degree matter. The uncertainty-history increment has its own numerical checks; building this site runs no science.

S0 smoke run

Source: s0_covariance.py · Reference factories

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py example
python3 -B tools/dev.py run examples/s0_covariance.py --prefix
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --native examples/s0_covariance.py \
  --prefix --derivatives manual --output "$PWD/results/s0-native-prefix"
```

The synthetic S0 study exercises a rigid binary, degree-2 estimated parameters, initial-state errors, position and attitude observations. `--prefix` integrates only one 600-second output interval and costs seconds. The deliberately small observation set leaves null directions; unavailable formal uncertainty is the correct result.

Without `--prefix` the script runs the full configured S0 study. `--dt` changes RK4 seconds; `--derivatives ad|manual` selects AD or hand-derived native partials. `--output` saves a **numeric artifact**, not the full standard figure gallery: epochs, native states, transition/sensitivity matrices, rows, layouts, singular/null information, covariance when available, reports and source hashes.

Custom binary

Source: custom_binary.py · Bodies and states

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py run examples/custom_binary.py
```

This is the smallest fully explicit body/state construction: two SI ellipsoids, a 2 km separation, a near-circular velocity scale, spin vectors and identity rotations. It selects masses, moments and initial-state errors, then requests one 600-second observation epoch with an RK4 step of 60 s. Astropy quantities make unit intent visible. Default AD is required; no plotting is needed. It prints unresolved directions and writes no results folder.

Use it as a starting point for your own script, but lengthen the study and validate its dynamics before interpreting scientific uncertainties. A geometrically convenient initial orbit is not a full-field equilibrium solve.

Reuse noise, priors and channels

Source: reuse_covariance.py · Reuse boundaries

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py reuse
```

A 1,200-second S0 prefix is propagated once. The script compares data-only covariance, an independent 5% primary-mass prior, doubled measurement noise and position-only channels. The new prior does not change the information carried by the data. The new noise and prior need no ODE evaluations; the compatible channel change reuses the checked transport. Output is printed summaries and a mass-properties report. Cost is seconds plus first AD compilation.

One Hera paper case

Source: hera_covariance.py · Complete annotated study

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py hera
```

The default is full tumbling (`AC3`), 16 mutual orbits, gravity order 6, both masses and raw degree-2/3/4 moments, free barycenter offset/rate, and the paper's combined Kaula prior. The script prints the paper-normalized report and writes a standard results folder including `paper` , `harmonics` and `mass` tables and PNG/SVG/PDF figures. It requests external LaTeX. The managed plotting environment includes JAX; there is no native fallback.

Historical full-case timings: about 1–2 minutes AD versus about 25 minutes native; Phase 2's concurrent AD acceptance took 199–201 seconds per case. To change the study, modify the readable `make_study(...)` call in your own runner. Available factory arguments are documented in the Hera chapter.

All four Hera cases

Source: hera_all_cases.py

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py hera_cases
python3 -B tools/dev.py hera_cases AC1 AC3 --jobs 1
python3 -B tools/dev.py run examples/hera_all_cases.py \
  AC3 --orbits 2 --no-export
```

The four cases share one factory and differ in initial rotation. Independent processes propagate each case, print progress and compare the nine selected uncertainty percentages to Table 2's printed rounding. With all cases the target is **36/36**. Default exports write one standard run per case; `--no-export` prints only; `--figures` adds plots when launched with `--plot`. Other options are `--orbits`, `--dt`, `--jobs` and `--output-root`.

The two-orbit command is a diagnostic prefix; its percentages are not expected to reproduce the 16-orbit table. A numerical conditioning refusal is reported, not patched by silently weakening the solver.

Hou native versus AD

Source: ad_covariance.py · Derivative methods

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py ad_example
```

The full S0 study runs twice with the same model, parameter selection, observation plan and RK4 settings. One provider is `NativeAnalyticTransport`; the other is the default Hou AD route. The script asserts equal posterior rank and mass/degree-2 sigma agreement at `rtol=1e-8`. Phase 2 observed a maximum mass/GM/ratio sigma difference of 5.5e-12 relative. It prints the checks and mass report; it writes no artifact. An earlier measured execution took about 35 seconds.

This is a useful same-problem backend comparison. It does not replace opt-in finite-difference checks or certify all nonlinear inference behavior.

Kaula laws and new shapes

Source: hera_kaula.py · Shapes and Kaula

```
# Refit the paper's retained coefficient clouds, no new meshes or trajectories.
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --plot examples/hera_kaula.py --tex

# Generate a small, new, seeded low-resolution shape/density ensemble.
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --plot examples/hera_kaula.py --fresh \
  --max-degree 4 --copies 3 --subdivisions 1
```

Archived mode verifies source cloud hashes, fits separate zonal/nonzonal power laws and checks all adopted law parameters/sigmas against the paper. It reproduces Figure 3 in roughly 10 seconds historically. The default input roots are BASCO's captured paper/Kaula ensembles; `--archive` and `--ensembles` replace them.

Fresh mode calls the generic mesh, radial sampler and core/shell/torus density components with a fixed seed. The CLI permits `--max-degree` 3–12, `--copies` per correlation length and `--subdivisions` for ellipsoid resolution. This is preprocessing, not trajectory integration. Cost grows with degree, mesh resolution and ensemble size. The demonstration is not a claim to reconstruct the full original 200-member random ensemble.

Outputs include PNG/SVG/PDF figures, `tables/kaula_laws.csv`, `tables/kaula_envelopes.csv`, `results.json`, `validation.json`, `README.md` and a byte manifest. `--output` selects a new destination; `--tex` is optional.

Degree, prior and gravity trades

Source: hera_degree_trades.py · Hera trade interpretation

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --plot examples/hera_degree_trades.py --help

# A fresh active-gravity-4 transport, default AD.
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --ad examples/hera_degree_trades.py propagate \
  --gravity-degree 4 --output "$PWD/results/hera-ac3-g4-ad-transport"

# Existing retained native transports are a different, explicit provider.
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --plot examples/hera_degree_trades.py compare \
  --derivatives native \
  --transport-root "$PWD/artifacts/scientific" \
  --output "$PWD/results/hera-degree-comparison" --figures
```

`propagate` accepts `--state`, `--gravity-degree`, `--dt`, `--duration`, required `--output` and `--derivatives ad|native`. It stores a fresh complete numeric transport artifact with source identity.

`compare` assembles six paper Figure 5 cases and additional symmetric degree/prior experiments from **completed BASCO transports**. It performs no new dynamics. It needs local transport artifacts named `hera-ac0-dt75-v1` through `hera-ac3-dt75-v1`; these large artifacts are ignored by Git and are not guaranteed to exist in a clean clone. The script does not download or fabricate them. `--gravity4-transport` adds a matched order-4 comparison, `--figures` draws the reports, and `--tex` requests LaTeX. Its default provider is native because the retained fixtures are native. All source transports in a comparison must match its declared provider.

The two commands above demonstrate separate activities: the newly produced AD order-4 artifact cannot be substituted into an otherwise native comparison. Choose one backend consistently and create/reuse the matching completed inputs. See the Hera chapter for the precise Figure 5 parameter spaces and null-direction caveats. Historical `compare` cost was about 20 seconds.

Multi-arc and tracking gaps

Source: multi_arc_covariance.py · Multi-arc guide

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py multi_arc
python3 -B tools/dev.py run examples/multi_arc_covariance.py --help
python3 -B tools/dev.py run examples/multi_arc_covariance.py \
  --state AC1 --days 7 --arc-days 3.5 --blackout 8
```

Defaults are AC3 full tumbling, Hou order 2, 14 days, 15-minute cadence, 8 h/day off, four 3.5-day arcs, RK4 75 s and AD. Masses/gravity are shared; each arc gets its own binary initial state and channel nuisance coordinates. Order 2 uses no field prior; `--order 4|6` estimates moments through degree 4 with the paper prior. Other options are `--cadence` in minutes, `--dt` in seconds, `--derivatives ad|manual`, and optional numeric-artifact `--output`.

The script compares a continuous ungapped study, the same continuous transport with a blackout, independent arcs, and a blackout sweep. Reweighting/selection in the sweep reuses per-arc transports. It prints a conditioning refusal when a continuous chaotic arc exceeds the solver guard; that refusal is an intended result. Historical default execution was about four minutes on the measured Mac; higher-order longer studies cost more.

These are covariance studies. The separate generic nonlinear batch driver exists, but this example does not fit actual Hera observations or apply a sequential filter.

Legacy gravity comparison

Source: gravity_models.py · Capability status

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py run --ad examples/gravity_models.py
```

This retained reference creates two point-mass lattices, propagates two orbits under exact mascon gravity, Hou orders 2/4/6 and Cartesian multipole orders 3/5, and prints trajectory differences and mass sigmas. It uses AD and selects masses/initial-state errors. It does not produce the Hera paper reproduction.

Cartesian multipole is deprecated compatibility code; the primary supported scientific workflow is Hou gravity. Mascons and second-degree reference utilities remain available but are outside current primary development. This example can be computationally heavier than a short S0 study and has no promised current timing.

Evidence tools are separate from user examples

Scripts under tools/evidence preserve numerical acceptance, archived replay and publication generation. They may require completed local artifacts. They are not all minimal tutorials, and not every one should be run to start a project. Use capabilities to distinguish available features from planned estimation/filter work.

CubeSat descent and landing covariance

The planned application is a first-contact location covariance for a CubeSat descending onto Didymos or Dimorphos. Inputs will include the joint binary state, mass and gravity uncertainty from a Hera-like analysis, plus a declared release uncertainty. Outputs will include body-fixed contact location, contact time and surface-relative velocity.

This landing application is not implemented. Current consider analysis and covariance histories propagate uncertainty in the binary and its ideal observables. A binary relative-position or barycentric-position history does not describe a CubeSat trajectory or landing footprint. Copied legacy landing scripts are available as implementation references, not as a validated public BASCO landing API.

The first target is an unpowered, massless point spacecraft in the time-dependent binary field, with a rigid prescribed target surface and a first-contact event. Navigation updates, thrust, spacecraft attitude/shape, rebound and final rest location require later components. The implementation roadmap owns the complete staged scope and acceptance criteria.

Planned components and order

Each stage has one numerical responsibility and can be checked independently of plotting and estimation strategy. Public runners should compose these components rather than contain alternate force or covariance equations.

Stage	Component	Required checks
L1	Joint uncertainty record: labels, units, reference epoch, frames, attitude tangents, nominal values, full covariance or supported factor/nullspace, and provenance.	Reordering and linear-map round trips; retention of state–field and estimated–consider cross terms; unsupported outputs remain unavailable.
L2	Binary background: positions, velocities, attitudes, angular rates and their joint-coordinate derivatives at requested epochs.	Hou native/AD agreement, frame and epoch checks, rotation-preserving interpolation, refinement below the descent uncertainty budget and no extrapolation.
L3	Spacecraft field and restricted dynamics: both bodies' gravity, position/parameter derivatives and optional additive force components.	Point-mass and sphere references, two-body superposition, frame invariance, optional finite differences and integration refinement.
L4	Release map and covariance transport: convert body, inertial or carrier-frame release conditions to spacecraft state and propagate the same model's sensitivities.	Inertial/body-frame equivalence; direct and indirect mass/attitude dependence; complete cross terms; small-uncertainty sampled checks.

Stage	Component	Required checks
L5	Surface and first-contact event: geometry, normal and gradients, first outside-to-inside crossing, event time and output derivatives.	Analytic plane/sphere cases; independently terminated finite-difference trajectories; rotating bodies; explicit grazing/edge failures and outcome classification.
L6	Footprint and contact reports: body-fixed and tangent-plane contact covariance, time, normal/tangential velocity, incidence angle and approach clearance.	Frame invariance, probability-content ellipse tests, cross-covariance checks and explicit limits of one local Gaussian map.
L7	Nonlinear validation and Hera-like example: a seeded ensemble using the same background, release, field, surface and event interfaces.	Empirical coverage, contact/no-contact/other-body-impact fractions with sampling uncertainty, outcome distributions and numerical refinement.

L1–L5 with a smooth sphere or ellipsoid provide the smallest useful validation case. L6–L7 are required before interpreting a plotted covariance as an asteroid landing prediction. A successful sphere case alone does not validate irregular-surface field accuracy or contact geometry.

Preserve the complete uncertainty

Let `u` be the declared input-error vector and `Z(t)` the fixed-time state Jacobian. Then

$$P_z(t) = Z(t) P_u Z(t)^T.$$

`Pu` must retain correlations among binary state, masses, moments, release conditions and any considered parameters. A consider result supplies the complete augmented error covariance, including estimated–consider blocks. Independently sampling estimated masses, moments and initial state would discard those correlations and define a different experiment.

Separate gravity-only and release-only contributions are meaningful when the relevant errors are independent by assumption. Otherwise the cross contribution belongs in the uncertainty budget and need not be positive by itself. Each exported study must state its independence assumptions, frames, epoch and covariance source.

Contact time is an uncertain output

A fixed-time position covariance at the nominal landing time is insufficient. Each perturbed trajectory generally reaches the surface at a different time.

For a smooth contact surface described by `g(t,z,u) = 0`, vector field `f` and nominal contact time `tau`, implicit differentiation gives

$$\tau_u = -\frac{g_z Z + g_u}{g_t + g_z f}.$$

For a reported event quantity `h(t,z,u)`, the event Jacobian is

$$J_{\text{event}} = h_z Z + h_u + (h_t + h_z f)\tau_u, \qquad P_{\text{event}} = J_{\text{event}} P_u J_{\text{event}}^T.$$

The denominator is the nominal surface-crossing rate. Grazing contact makes this map ill-conditioned. Mesh edges, changing first-contact locations, no-contact outcomes or a different impacted body can invalidate a single smooth local derivative. Such cases need explicit diagnostics and nonlinear sampled outcomes, not a finite ellipse produced by ignoring the event.

Body-fixed contact position must also include uncertainty in target COM, attitude and contact time. Surface-relative velocity requires the target's translational and rotational motion at that same contact event. Post-contact bouncing and settling need an additional contact/reset model and its sensitivities.

Field and surface validity

Hou remains the coupled binary mutual-gravity model. A finite exterior moment expansion adequate for the mutual orbit is not automatically accurate near an irregular surface. The spacecraft field component needs a declared spatial validity domain, convergence/refinement evidence and a near-surface reference comparison.

Estimated moments do not uniquely determine an interior density or the local field near the surface. The mapping from estimated mass/moments to the chosen spacecraft field must therefore be explicit and differentiable. A uniform-density polyhedral field is one candidate nominal provider; scaling one shape's density is not equivalent to varying all independent estimated harmonic directions.

Geometry and mass distribution remain distinct inputs. Later surface uncertainty may include scale, shape modes, registration, COM-to-center-of-figure offsets, local normals and topography, with correlations to moments or density. Independently sampled meshes and moments can describe inconsistent bodies unless their statistical relationship is specified.

Footprint interpretation

For a smooth nominal contact point, a two-row orthonormal tangent basis `T` maps body-fixed contact covariance to

$$P_{\text{surface}} = T P_{\text{contact}} T^T.$$

The output must retain the tangent basis, origin and normal. A large, curved or multimodal footprint belongs on the surface geometry; a local planar ellipse may be inadequate.

For a locally Gaussian two-dimensional error distribution, a probability-content ellipse has semiaxes

$$a_i = \sqrt{\chi^2_2(p)\lambda_i}.$$

Here `lambda_i` are tangent-plane covariance eigenvalues and `p` is the stated probability content. A 95% ellipse uses a Mahalanobis radius of approximately 2.448. A radius of 3 contains approximately 98.89% in two dimensions. Label the probability explicitly; a footprint ellipse alone does not establish safe touchdown, rebound or final-rest probability.

Validation and reusable material

BASCO contains migration copies of the earlier restricted-three-body landing runner, surface helpers, impact events and example meshes. Before reuse, their units, geometry registration, rotation conventions, derivative support, field domains and event semantics must be checked. Cubic interpolation of individual attitude-matrix entries does not guarantee a valid rotation or consistent attitude sensitivities.

Acceptance will compare first-order predictions with independently event-terminated perturbed runs and a seeded ensemble. Each sample must find its own contact time and record contact, no contact, other-body impact or numerical failure. The nominal and sampled models must agree. Refinement must cover integration, background interpolation, gravity approximation and surface representation.

The initial Didymos–Dimorphos study should compare gravity-only, release-only and full correlated uncertainty budgets using the same modular components. Publication should include source identities, assumptions, numerical settings, covariance and sampled footprint, contact-condition distributions and uncertainty in empirical coverage.

The roadmap cites Celik et al., A comparative reliability analysis of ballistic deployments on binary asteroids, Fodde et al., Design and Analysis of Robust Ballistic Landings on the Secondary of a Binary Asteroid, and Kong et al., Saltation Matrices. These provide application and event-sensitivity references; none substitutes for implementing and validating BASCO's stated model.

Equations and conventions

BASCO linearizes predicted measurements about a nominal binary trajectory and combines their derivatives with measurement noise and prior information. The resulting covariance describes the local uncertainty in the selected masses, gravity parameters and initial-state coordinates. Numerical rank diagnostics identify parameter combinations that are not constrained under those assumptions.

A covariance forecast is local to the supplied model, state, observation geometry and statistical assumptions. It does not fit measured data, establish the accuracy of the nominal model or quantify bias from gravity truncation.

Computation stages

Stage	Input	Output	Main component
Physical model	Bodies, moments, relative state and mutual gravity order	Nominal full two-body dynamics	BinaryDynamics
Solve-for map	Selected masses, inertia/field coordinates and initial-state treatment	Named independent coordinates and raw-moment Jacobian	Parameters
Variational propagation	Model, coordinates, integration grid and derivative provider	States, state transition and parameter sensitivities	Transport
Observation assembly	Propagation, channels, direct derivatives and nuisance	Physical unweighted design rows	LinearizedStudy
Statistical solve	Rows, noise, priors, scales and numerical support policy	Covariance, nullspace and diagnostics	CovarianceResult
Reporting	Result plus physical maps	Mass/gravity tables, plots and verified exports	make_presentation

The same components are used in the first example and the Hera reproduction. Physical models, measurement statistics, numerical solving and plotting are configured independently.

Variational equations

Let `x` denote the native integration state and `p` the independent physical parameters. The dynamics and local derivatives give:

$$\dot{x} = F(x, p), \qquad A = \frac{\partial F}{\partial x}, \qquad B = \frac{\partial F}{\partial p}.$$

The propagated state transition and sensitivities satisfy:

$$\dot{\Phi} = A\Phi, \quad \Phi(0) = I, \qquad \dot{\Psi} = A\Psi + B, \quad \Psi(0) = 0.$$

BASCO transports raw-moment sensitivities and maps them into the independent coordinate basis. A mass direction changes all retained dimensional moments associated with that body's mass. Treating mass as only a monopole derivative would omit part of the implemented physical chain.

For an observation prediction `h`, the design rows include both propagated and direct terms:

$$H_p = h_x \Psi + h_p, \qquad H_{x_0} = h_x \Phi L_0.$$

`L_0` lifts an 18-dimensional physical initial-state error into the 30-component native state. Local observation nuisance supplies additional columns. The direct `h_p` term is essential for Didymos position relative to the system barycenter.

Units and attitude coordinates

The public physical boundary uses SI and radians. The retained native codec uses kilometre-based translation and matrix attitude entries. BASCO performs the conversions and provides physical tangent maps; users should not independently convert public lengths to kilometres.

Two attitude matrices contain 18 scalar entries, but only six physical attitude-error directions. Covariance uses local SO(3) attitude errors instead of treating all matrix entries as independent rotations. See bodies and states.

Statistical interpretation

Whitening transforms the observation residual/design using its declared covariance. Characteristic column scales make differently dimensioned estimated parameters numerically comparable. The numerical solve operates on whitened, scaled rows and maps supported uncertainty back to physical units.

For full supported rank, the familiar expression is:

$$P = (H^T R^{-1} H + J_{\text{prior}}^T R_{\text{prior}}^{-1} J_{\text{prior}})^{-1}.$$

The implementation uses square-root QR/SVD methods. The result records the rank threshold, eliminated nuisance parameters and physical scaling used in the calculation.

A scale is not a prior. A prior adds knowledge; a numerical threshold selects what the finite-precision calculation supports. A fixed parameter is conditioned on its nominal, not estimated perfectly by the observations.

Hou gravity and derivative methods

Hou mutual gravity at total orders 2, 4 and 6 is the main scientific path. Default transport uses automatic differentiation of a separate JAX-compatible Hou value implementation. NativeAnalyticTransport preserves manual analytic derivatives. Both feed the same physical-coordinate, observation and statistical machinery.

Finite differences provide an explicit, optional check. They do not run inside normal covariance analysis. Neither AD nor native agreement alone proves all physics, frames and parameter choices correct; independent equations, finite differences, conservation/refinement and reference reproduction serve different purposes.

Cartesian multipole gravity is deprecated compatibility. Mascons remain available for reference and extension use. These retained models do not change the Hou-centered scope of the toolkit.

Estimation interfaces

BASCO includes frozen-linear multi-arc corrections and a generic callback-based nonlinear batch/MAP driver. Binary observation ingestion, complete measured-attitude residuals, seeded mission-style recovery and sequential filters remain unfinished adapters/features. Multi-arc and estimation makes that boundary explicit.

For implementation details, begin with the mathematical contracts, extension contracts and current validation evidence.

Glossary and notation

Use this page when a matrix label or physical quantity is unclear. Array shape alone does not identify its frame, units or uncertainty coordinates. The API reference supplies exact signatures; concepts connects the components.

Names and frames

Term	Meaning in BASCO
BASCO	Binary Asteroid Simulation, Covariance, and Observability
Primary / `A`	First body; Didymos in the Hera benchmark
Secondary / `B`	Second body; Dimorphos in the Hera benchmark
`N`	Inertial resolving frame
`A`	Primary body-fixed principal-axis frame
`B`	Secondary body-fixed principal-axis frame
`A_to_N`, `C_NA`	Rotation multiplying A components to obtain N components
`B_to_A`, `C_AB`	Rotation multiplying B components to obtain A components
`C_NB`	Secondary-to-inertial rotation, `C_NA @ C_AB`
DCM	Direction cosine matrix, a proper 3 × 3 rotation
Principal-axis representation	Centered moments with first moments and products of inertia structurally zero; current maintained rigid-body domain
Left attitude perturbation	`C_new = Exp(skew(delta_theta)) @ C`; the rotation vector lives in the rotation's destination frame
SO(3)	Manifold of proper 3D rotations; attitude covariance uses local three-component tangents

BinaryState stores inertial position/velocity and both inertial spin rates **resolved in A**. Its velocity is not the time derivative of position components in the rotating A frame. Changing a resolving frame requires the appropriate rotation/kinematic transformation.

Physical symbols and units

Symbol / field	Meaning	Units
`G` , `G_SI`	Fixed gravitational constant of the model	$m^3\ kg^{-1}\ s^{-2}$
`M_A` , `M_B`	Primary and secondary mass	kg
`GM` / gravitational parameter	`G × M` ; report derived with fixed G	$m^3\ s^{-2}$
`system.mass_ratio`	`M_B / M_A`	Dimensionless
`r_A` , `position`	Secondary-minus-primary inertial relative position resolved in A	m
`v_A` , `velocity`	Inertial relative velocity resolved in A	$m\ s^{-1}$
`rho_N`	Inertial relative position, `C_NA @ r_A`	m
`omega_A_A`	Primary inertial spin resolved in A	$rad\ s^{-1}$
`omega_B_A`	Secondary inertial spin resolved in A	$rad\ s^{-1}$
`theta_A_N`	Left primary attitude error resolved in N	rad
`theta_B_A`	Left relative-attitude error resolved in A	rad
`R0` , `barycenter.offset.*`	Constant barycenter position nuisance at the reference epoch	m
`V0` , `barycenter.rate.*`	Barycenter velocity nuisance	$m\ s^{-1}$
`t` , epoch	Elapsed time on the study grid	s
`dt`	Fixed RK4 integration step	s
Cadence	Time between epochs on the observation base grid	s
`R` , reference radius	Fixed normalization radius of a body	m
Bounding radius	Declared exterior-domain geometry bound; distinct from normalization radius	m

Public constructors accept the documented SI scalars/arrays or compatible Astropy quantities. Do not feed degrees into a bare angular sigma expecting an implicit degree conversion: use `np.deg2rad(...)` or an explicit `u.deg` quantity. Unit strings such as `m2` , `m3` and `kg m2` in saved layouts mean powers/products, not new parameter types.

Native30 and physical18

The retained propagator stores two DCMs explicitly. Its 30 storage values are not 30 independent physical state errors.

Native slice	Stored quantity	Stored units
`0:3`	Relative position in A	km
`3:6`	Inertial relative velocity in A	km s^{-1}
`6:9`	Primary spin in A	rad s^{-1}
`9:12`	Secondary spin in A	rad s^{-1}
`12:21`	`C_NA` , flattened row-major	Dimensionless
`21:30`	`C_AB` , flattened row-major	Dimensionless

The independent physical tangent has 18 entries, in this order:

```
delta r_A [3]          m
delta v_A [3]          m/s
delta omega_A_A [3]    rad/s
delta omega_B_A [3]    rad/s
delta theta_A_N [3]    rad
delta theta_B_A [3]    rad
```

physical_lift maps physical18 errors to native30 increments. physical_dual is the left inverse; it is not simply the transpose of the lift. retract_native applies the physical error, including left rotation updates. It does not silently project or normalize the nominal state.

`BinaryState.from_native(..., project=True)` explicitly projects a propagated DCM to a nearby proper rotation before constructing a new valid initial state. High-level arcs use this to remove RK4 orthogonality drift. On chaotic tumbling that tiny restart change can grow; see multi-arc.

The state codec source is the single owner of the native layout. Standard plots decode position into SI and do not reinterpret raw state columns as meters.

Gravity, moments and inertia

Term / symbol	Definition and caution
Raw inertia integral `T_lmn`	`integral x^l y^m z^n dm` , dimensional units kg m^(l+m+n)
Mass-normalized moment `That_lmn`	`T_lmn / M` , units m^(l+m+n); these are the raw-moment **estimated parameter coordinates** despite the shorter labels
`primary.T200`	Primary normalized `integral x² dm / M` , in m^2; not dimensional `Ixx`
Degree	`l + m + n` for a moment; spherical-harmonic degree `l` for `C_lm` / `S_lm`
Mutual order	Total retained order of the Hou interaction expansion; maintained values 2, 4, 6

Term / symbol	Definition and caution
Nominal degree	Degree available in the body's fixed moment table
Estimated degree	Degree of independent coordinates varied in the covariance calculation; may be lower than nominal degree/gravity order
`C_lm`, `S_lm`	Exterior cosine/sine gravity harmonics; normalization and fixed reference radius must accompany values
Zonal	Harmonic order `m = 0`
Nonzonal	Harmonic order `m > 0`; Kaula fits use a degree-wise RMS magnitude
Trace complement / trace gauge	Raw-moment directions not specified by exterior harmonics; harmonic-coordinate updates keep a declared complement fixed
Structural null direction	A parameter combination to which the given exterior data are mathematically insensitive; extra precision does not create information
Dimensional `Izz`	`M × (That_200 + That_020)`, in kg m²
Normalized polar moment	`Izz/(M R²) = (That_200 + That_020)/R²`, dimensionless

For centered principal axes, the general degree-2 report uses

$$C_{20} = \frac{2\widehat{T}_{002} - \widehat{T}_{200} - \widehat{T}_{020}}{2R^2}, \qquad C_{22} = \frac{\widehat{T}_{200} - \widehat{T}_{020}}{4R^2}.$$

These are **unnormalized** coefficients. hera_report converts to the paper's 4π geodesy normalization with no Condon–Shortley phase, and reports dimensionless polar moment. Always read a report's `conventions` before comparing another source. Varying a mass at fixed normalized shape changes dimensional moments and inertia consistently; it does not mean the shape coordinates are fixed dimensional integrals.

Priors and Kaula rules

Term	Meaning
Prior	Explicit independent information about a named quantity, with its source/reference/units and covariance
Gaussian prior	A mean and positive covariance mapped into selected study coordinates; omitted mean uses the nominal for a covariance study
Pseudo-residual row	A whitened prior residual/Jacobian assembled alongside measurement information
Kaula law	Degree-dependent envelope of harmonic uncertainty, here separate zonal/nonzonal fitted power laws
`K`, `alpha`	Power-law scale and slope in `K × degree^(-alpha)`

Term	Meaning
Fit degrees	Degrees used to infer a power law from an ensemble
Apply degrees	Degrees receiving prior uncertainty; a separate scientific choice
Upper envelope	Adopted bound informed by fitted scatter/interior variants; not an observed posterior
Shape ensemble	Seeded or archived perturbed geometry members with the declared coefficient normalization
Density variants	Prescribed core, shell or torus alternatives; not recovered internal-density estimates
Raw-moment prior rows	Additional independent moment information derived using the declared conversion; the paper uses these as well as harmonic rows
Fixed coordinate	Omitted estimated parameter; no uncertainty is being estimated for it. It is not a zero-width numerical prior

The Hera baseline constrains 36 harmonic and 56 raw-moment rows; masses and local coordinates receive no prior. The prior must be counted once when physical parameters are shared over arcs. Shapes and Kaula explains the modular producers.

Linearization, matrices and numerical support

Symbol / term	Meaning
RHS / `f`	Equations of motion, `dx/dt = f(x,p)`
State Jacobian / `A`	Derivative of the RHS with respect to the declared state coordinates; do not confuse with frame A
Parameter Jacobian / `B`	Derivative of the RHS with respect to declared parameter directions; do not confuse with body B
`Phi` , state transition	Sensitivity of the propagated state to initial state
`Psi`	Parameter sensitivity; distinguish raw-SI and independent-physical-coordinate forms
Design row / `H`	Linearized observation dependence on the full study coordinate layout
Direct parameter partial	Observation dependence on parameters outside the transported state; barycentric mass ratio is an example
Whitening	Apply the declared inverse noise factor to rows/residuals before analysis
Characteristic scale	Positive numerical conversion for mixed-unit columns; no physical prior information
QR / square root	Factorization of whitened rows without first forming ill-conditioned normal equations
SVD	Singular-value decomposition identifying numerical support/null directions
Data rank	Numerical supported dimension from measurements alone under the selected scaling/cutoff
Posterior rank	Numerical supported dimension after the stated priors are included

Symbol / term	Meaning
Marginal physical rank	Support of the physical block after local nuisance elimination
Rank cutoff / `rank_rtol`	Numerical threshold relative to the recorded spectrum; not a scientific prior
Nullspace	Directions not constrained by the analyzed information
Condition number	Ratio of relevant largest/smallest singular values; values near floating-point limits depend strongly on rounding
Nuisance projection	Eliminate local coordinates before diagnosing the marginal physical square root
Cross covariance	Off-diagonal uncertainty coupling between coordinate groups; essential in derived mass/inertia reports
Formal 1σ	Local standard deviation conditional on the nominal model, measurements, priors and numerical support policy
Relative uncertainty	`sigma / abs(nominal)`; undefined for a zero nominal coefficient
Prior/posterior gain	Prior sigma divided by posterior sigma, for compatible reported quantities

For a supported derived quantity with Jacobian `J`, covariance transforms as `C_y = J C_x J.T`. If a requested derivative projects into an unconstrained direction, BASCO reports unavailable uncertainty rather than using a pseudoinverse to manufacture finite knowledge. Numerical rank is not automatically a physical observability count, particularly on long chaotic arcs.

The covariance solvers own the support policy; changing derivative backend should not silently change that policy. See statistics.

Derivative methods

Term	Meaning and current status
Analytic/native	Preserved hand-derived Hou partials evaluated through compiled native code; explicitly selectable
AD	Automatic differentiation of the separate maintained Hou value equations; default JAX transport
JAX	Optional AD dependency, loaded lazily; CPU float64 is the recorded acceptance route
FD	Finite differences of independent value evaluations under physical perturbations; user-invoked validation, not routine production propagation
Retraction	Apply a physical local correction on the state manifold before a value evaluation
Known zero derivative	Explicit mathematical independence; different from missing/unsupported derivative capability
Derivative backend	Provider chosen to produce the required partials/transport; choice belongs in provenance/cache identity

AD does not remove the need to choose a physical parameterization or test equations. It differentiates the implemented value code; an incorrect value model can have perfectly consistent AD. The preserved native route and independent FD checks provide complementary evidence. See derivatives.

Arcs, estimation and results

Term	Meaning
Arc	A time interval with its own local initial-state uncertainty
Shared parameter	One physical coordinate common to every arc, such as a body mass
Arc-local coordinate	An initial-state/nuisance coordinate independently estimated for one arc
Independent arcs	No dynamical continuity penalty or implicit process noise connects the local states
Linear correction	One weighted solution of a frozen residual/Jacobian system; does not certify nonlinear convergence
Batch/MAP iteration	Rebuild/relinearize around updated estimates while counting measurement/prior information correctly
Sequential filter	Repeated prediction/update estimator; planned, not a delivered BASCO feature
Transport	Frozen trajectory and variational sensitivities with a checked identity
LinearizedStudy	Rows, layouts, priors, observation metadata and checked transport ready for repeat analysis
CovarianceResult	Numerical covariance/support result with optional physical-report service
DerivedReport	Named values, units, Jacobian, covariance, sigma/status and conventions
Presentation	Canonical table/figure dataset built from a result; not a new dynamics calculation
Numeric artifact	Atomic JSON/NPY folder with byte hashes and completion metadata
Standard run	Study export with descriptive identity, tables/arrays/provenance and optional figures
Transport identity	Compatibility statement for model, nominal state, epoch grid, integration and provider; channels/noise can vary when compatible
Analysis identity	Scientific analysis configuration including rows, noise, prior and scales; elapsed timing does not change it
Manifest	Byte sizes and SHA256 hashes used to verify a saved folder
Snapshot	Recorded arrays/identities/tables for exact refactor comparison on the stated host
Fresh propagation	New BASCO dynamics and variational integration
Archived-row replay	Analyze converted saved producer rows with no new dynamics; different evidence from fresh propagation
Model-conditioned trade	Compare covariance under two declared models; not an automatic estimate of modeling bias

See workflow, multi-arc, results and capability status.

Derivative validation

BASCO preserves the manual analytic Hou implementation and provides an independent JAX-compatible value implementation differentiated automatically. **Hou AD is the default.** Finite differences are an explicit diagnostic, not part of normal covariance runs.

Choose the route in the study

For `model`, `parameters`, `plan` and `bc` from your ordinary composition:

```
# Default: automatic differentiation of the copied Hou equations.
ad_study = bc.CovarianceStudy(model, parameters, plan, integrator=bc.RK4(60.0))

# Explicit manual analytic route, without JAX.
native_study = bc.CovarianceStudy(
    model, parameters, plan,
    integrator=bc.RK4(60.0),
    transport=bc.NativeAnalyticTransport(),
)
```

Explicit AD selection is also available:

```
from basco.ad import ADTransport
ad_study = bc.CovarianceStudy(model, parameters, plan, transport=ADTransport())
```

The managed plain `run` environment includes AD; `run --native` is analytic-only; `run --plot` includes AD and plotting. An environment flag does not change a provider explicitly chosen inside a script.

Importing BASCO, constructing `ADTransport` and describing a study do not load JAX. Propagation loads the optional dependency. If JAX is unavailable, the error asks for the AD extra or explicit native selection. There is no implicit fallback.

What automatic differentiation changes

AD evaluates exact chain-rule derivatives of the operations in the implemented floating-point value function. It avoids manually maintaining every algebraic partial, and does not subtract perturbed forward values as finite differences do. It is still subject to the model's equations, conventions, floating-point arithmetic and integration accuracy.

BASCO's AD evaluator computes force/torque derivatives and the dynamics `F`, `A = dF/dx` and raw-moment `B`. The shared augmented fixed-RK4 integrator propagates the same variational structure. The provider converts raw sensitivities into the declared SI moment units before returning transport.

This is AD of the implemented continuous right-hand side integrated through variational equations. It is not a blanket differentiation of an entire user runner, file I/O, plotting, rank-threshold decisions or arbitrary custom observations. Existing physical-coordinate maps and observation partials remain important explicit links.

The maintained domain is centered/principal-axis rigid, autonomous Hou orders 2/4/6, fixed RK4 and uniform positive output epochs. Arbitrary deformation, collisions, off-grid observation epochs and new forces do not become supported merely because JAX can differentiate Python operations.

Find the equations in the source

The mathematical chain is deliberately split into recognizable owners:

Equation or map	Source to read
Retained Hou potential, moment rotation and native `hou_ode`	Native GUBAS core
Hand-derived evaluator and prepared derivative access	analytic.py, kernels.py
Copied Hou contraction tables and potential	ad/hou_tables.py, ad/gravity.py
Copied equations of motion and AD evaluator	ad/dynamics.py, ad/evaluator.py
Shared variational RK4 stages	integration.py
Independent parameters to raw moments; physical state tangents	coordinates.py, state.py
Observation/direct mass terms and row assembly	observations.py, linearization.py
Exterior coefficient and reported-quantity maps	harmonics.py, reports.py

Read these with the math-flow overview, rather than treating the derivative backend as a single opaque Jacobian. The API inventory describes signatures and fields; source links expose the implemented equations themselves.

Compare both methods at matched inputs

```
ad_rows = ad_study.linearize()
native_rows = native_study.linearize()
ad_result = ad_rows.covariance()
native_result = native_rows.covariance()
print(ad_result.mass_properties().summary())
print(native_result.mass_properties().summary())
```

These are two genuine propagations. Compare physics, scales, rows, ranks and reports at the same model/state, epochs, integration step, parameter basis, noise, priors and solver. A timing comparison with different assumptions is not a derivative-backend benchmark.

The AD example runs the native/default-AD Hou comparison. Default/native snapshots and the fresh four-case Hera rerun passed the Phase 2 acceptance. The paper's 36 printed Table 2 values reproduced through default AD. This is evidence for the tested configurations, not universal certification of all future extensions.

Run the built-in finite-difference checks

From the checkout:

```
python3 -B tools/dev.py validate
python3 -B tools/dev.py ad_validate
```

`validate` selects native FD checks; `ad_validate` selects AD checks. Ordinary `test`, covariance and export commands do not launch FD probes. Existing validation covers selected local dynamics, raw/physical maps, observations and reports. Complete end-to-end and covariance-propagation coverage remains unfinished; read each record's requested directions and settings.

A small independent derivative check

The following standalone example demonstrates the public validation engine on a simple nonlinear function. It does not validate binary dynamics:

```python
import numpy as np
from basco.validation import ProbeRequest, Tolerances, validate_jacobian

def forward(x):
    return np.array([x[0]**2, x[0] * x[1]])

def jacobian(x):
    return np.array([[2.0 * x[0], 0.0], [x[1], x[0]]])

request = ProbeRequest(
    point=np.array([2.0, 3.0]),
    input_scales=np.ones(2),
    output_scales=np.ones(2),
    steps=(1e-2, 1e-3, 1e-4, 1e-5, 1e-6),
    input_ids=("x", "y"),
    output_ids=("x_squared", "x_times_y"),
    provenance={"purpose": "validation-engine tutorial"},
)
print(request.preview())
check = validate_jacobian(
    forward,
    jacobian,
    request,
    Tolerances(atol=1e-8, rtol=1e-8, fd_atol=1e-7, fd_rtol=1e-7),
    name="two_variable_example",
    equation_id="tutorial.polynomial",
    provider="manual_analytic",
)
print(check.summary())
check.write("validation/two-variable-example")
```

ProbeRequest declares physical point, positive input/output scales, decreasing dimensionless step sizes, directions and named axes. Optional `directions` has shape `(input coordinates, selected directions)`; probing a subset does not certify the rest. `preview()` estimates forward-call cost before evaluation.

Tolerances separately controls analytic agreement and FD-reference stability. The engine chooses a reference step from agreement among FD samples, independently of the proposed analytic derivative. Forward roundoff limits, failed evaluations and unrepresentable perturbations are recorded. `pass`, `mismatch` and `inconclusive` are different outcomes.

Validate physical directions

For binary attitude, supply a retraction inside the forward adapter and perturb physical SO(3) tangents. Do not independently perturb nine matrix entries. For masses and moments, update the entire declared physical map, including coupled dimensional moments. Use scales even at zero nominal coefficients.

DerivativeRegistry and JacobianCheck organize explicitly selected checks with equation IDs, and report unrequested coverage. There is no hidden global import-time registry.

FD artifacts save points/scales, sampled derivative actions, selected steps, statuses and provenance without overwriting an existing baseline. Derivative checks complement integration-step refinement, conservation and reference comparisons; none substitutes for all the others.

See AUTODIFF, derivative-validation design and the validation source for detailed contracts.

Extension interfaces

BASCO components implement explicit Python interfaces. A custom component can be passed to the relevant study or export object when it supplies the required methods and attributes. Inputs and outputs must declare their units, frames, coordinate order and settings used to check reuse.

Interfaces

New capability	Interface	Required behavior
Measurement	ObservationChannel	Labels, units, positive sigmas, state and direct physical prediction partials
Timing/visibility	ObservationSchedule	Boolean mask on existing epochs and complete JSON description
Alternative gravity declaration	GravityModel	Mutual order and optional compatibility/identity settings
Custom AD potential	DifferentiableGravityModel	JAX-traceable SI mutual potential
One variational evaluation	VariationalEvaluator	Callable returning native-layout `F`, `A`, `B`
Propagation backend	TransportProvider	Capabilities, preparation, integration and checked transport identity
Measurement statistics	NoiseModel	Consistent vector/matrix whitening and complete settings
Physical prior	PriorProvider	Prior rows, mean/reference, layouts, noise and provenance
Covariance strategy	CovarianceSolver	Support policy, covariance/null/cross information and diagnostics
Linear correction	LeastSquaresSolver	A correction using the covariance's same support decision
Figure	PlotDefinition	A result-data draw function and caption

Protocols are runtime-checkable, but `isinstance(...)` only confirms structural member presence. The consumer still validates returned shapes, finite values, units and identities. A successful structural check is not scientific conformance evidence.

Add a covariance range channel

This example reuses the existing relative-position derivative and applies a line-of-sight chain rule. It is a covariance prediction-direction channel, not a complete observed-range data adapter:

```python
import numpy as np
import basco as bc

class RelativeRange:
    labels = ("relative_range",)
    units = ("m",)
    sigma = 1.0

    def linearize_native(self, x, parameters):
        position_rows, direct = bc.RelativePosition().linearize_native(x, parameters)
        rho = 1000.0 * (x[12:21].reshape(3, 3) @ x[:3])
        line = rho / np.linalg.norm(rho)
        return line[None, :] @ position_rows, line[None, :] @ direct

plan = bc.ObservationPlan.uniform(
    stop=3600.0,
    cadence=600.0,
    channels=(RelativeRange(),),
)
```

The channel returns `(dh/dnative30, direct dh/dphysical_parameters)`. The native matrix and kilometre conversion appear here because this low-level observation adapter explicitly consumes native30. Ordinary runners should continue using physical classes rather than copying native indices elsewhere.

Declare known zero derivatives as zero arrays of the required shape. An omitted derivative is unavailable and is not interpreted as zero. Validate the new channel independently before using it in a study with either Hou derivative method.

The dynamics AD default does not automatically differentiate this custom observation. General custom-observable AD remains unfinished.

Optional observation capabilities

`ObservationChannel` requires only labels, units, sigma and `linearize_native`. Separate optional contracts in contracts.py describe:

Optional contract	Added capability
`ScheduledObservation`	A `schedule` selecting existing epochs
`NuisanceObservation`	Independent nuisance layout and `nuisance_partials(epoch)`
`ValueObservation`	An absolute `value_native(...)` prediction

A covariance-only channel need not claim absolute values. Conversely, a value predictor alone does not provide covariance partials. PolynomialBias and PrimaryBarycentricPosition show how nuisance and direct mass dependence remain modular.

Gravity models

The recommended model is `HouGravity(mutual_order=2/4/6)` with its dedicated native or AD evaluator. It is a gravity declaration whose adapters own the equations; it need not implement a custom-potential method.

A custom differentiable model instead supplies:

```
def potential(self, r, C_AB, T_A, T_B, G):
    ...  # Return the JAX-traceable mutual potential in joules.
```

The contract inputs are SI: relative position in primary components, secondary-to-primary rotation, raw mass-weighted moment tables and G. Declare every model setting affecting physics through identity settings. `moment_solve_fors=False` explicitly refuses unsupported independent moment/harmonic directions. `check_model(model)` can validate body compatibility.

Such a model requires an explicit compatible AD provider; it is never silently run through native Hou. Cartesian multipole is deprecated compatibility, and mascons/second-degree example models are retained reference utilities outside active Hou development. See gravity-model evidence before treating a retained alternative as a maintained general workflow.

Replace the evaluator or provider

The common variational integrator requires a callable returning shapes `(30,)`, `(30, 30)` and `(30, n_raw_slots)`. Its `B` follows the declared raw-slot order and native kg km^n moment units. The transport converts raw-moment derivatives to public SI units. A custom evaluator must preserve that distinction between native-state and moment-derivative units.

A provider returns Transport with matching epochs, state order, raw slots, physical/raw sensitivities, diagnostics and TransportIdentity. Observations, priors and solver are configured separately. Reuse requires a matching identity; array shapes alone do not establish compatibility.

Numerical results and figure generation

Numerical solvers consume named rows and coordinate layouts. Physical report transformations are supplied separately through resolved parameters. A generic numerical result requires those transformations before it can report binary-specific masses or gravity quantities.

Presentation consumes result/report data and never recomputes gravity or covariance. To add a figure, return a Matplotlib figure from a `PlotDefinition.draw(dataset, theme)` callback and let the ordinary writer handle format selection, files and captions. Preserve row statuses instead of replacing unsupported uncertainty by zero bars.

Extension validation

Before calling an extension complete, record its owner and input/output layouts; provide units, frame and epoch conventions; declare every physics/statistics setting in identity/provenance; validate shapes and unavailable capabilities; compare an independent small case or FD action; and demonstrate it in an ordinary readable runner.

Avoid a new global registry or application singleton when an explicit object can carry the behavior. Keep code with the model, observation, statistical or presentation owner that gives it scientific meaning. Troubleshooting covers the common boundary failures.

Capabilities and limits

BASCO computes **formal local covariance for binary-asteroid masses and gravity**, using the Hou/GUBAS full two-body dynamics. The tables below distinguish implemented and validated capabilities from partial interfaces and planned work.

Supported means implemented with recorded checks in the stated domain. **Partial** means some components are implemented, while the complete workflow or its validation remains open. **Legacy** means retained compatibility/reference functionality. **Planned** means unimplemented work.

Bodies, gravity and integration

Feature	Status	Scope and entry point
Rigid autonomous binary	Supported	Centered principal-axis body representation; BinarySystem, BinaryDynamics
Uniform ellipsoids	Supported	SI axes/density and nominal moments; UniformEllipsoid
Explicit moment tables	Supported	Complete nominal moments with fixed reference/bounding radii; MomentDistribution
Closed triangular meshes/OBJ	Supported	Geometry validation, centering/principal alignment, moments and distribution construction; TriangleMesh
Seeded shape/density ensembles	Supported	Radial perturbations and core/shell/torus alternatives; RadialShapeSampler, DensityVariation
Hou mutual orders 2, 4, 6	Supported, primary path	Order is independent of nominal input degree and selected estimated parameters; HouGravity
Fixed-step RK4 augmented transport	Supported	Native30 storage with consistent state/sensitivity epochs; RK4
Exterior-domain checks	Supported	Available body moments and declared bounding geometry checked; this is not a contact/collision dynamics model
Exact mascon, second-degree reference models	Legacy/reference	Implemented AD utilities retained outside the primary Hou development target
Cartesian multipole gravity	Deprecated legacy	Old imports remain; construction warns; implementation under `basco.ad.legacy`
Independent degree-5/6 estimated parameters	Planned	Degree-6 **nominal gravity** works; this does not expose independent uncertain degree-5/6 coordinates
Adaptive integrators, events, external perturbations	Planned	Current public study path is the documented fixed-step autonomous model

Feature	Status	Scope and entry point
Deformation/contact/free non-principal representation	Planned	Not implied by a generic gravity contract

See bodies and states, derivatives and gravity compatibility evidence.

Parameters and physical reports

Feature	Status	Scope and entry point
Both masses	Supported	Positive mass coordinates with full effect on force, inertia and reports; Parameters
Degree-2 normalized moments	Supported	Three diagonal principal-axis moments per body
Raw degree-3/4 moments	Supported	Complete monomial coordinates; trace null directions are retained
Exterior degree-3/4 harmonic coordinates	Supported	Fixed reference radius; fixed trace complement; body-specific selections
18 physical initial-state errors	Supported	SI position, velocity, spins and six local attitude errors; distinct from native30 storage
Explicit coordinate scales/layouts	Supported	Stable labels and units; scales improve numerical conditioning and add no information; CoordinateLayout
Fixed-G mass, GM, total and ratio reports	Supported	Uses full joint covariance; CovarianceResult
Harmonics and dimensional inertia reports	Supported	Report conventions are recorded; paper-normalized report is separate
Custom derived report	Supported	User value/Jacobian with declared labels/units and nullspace-aware transformation
Conditioning a compatible estimated parameter subset	Supported	Reuses rows while treating omitted estimated parameters as fixed, not marginalized uncertainty
Mesh-vertex/density/mascon estimated parameters	Planned	Nominal preprocessing or a reference value model does not imply estimable geometry
Estimating G separately from masses	Planned	Current G is fixed in the model

See parameters, results and the glossary for conventions. A reported fixed coefficient is different from an estimated coefficient with informative data.

Measurements and schedules

Feature	Status	Scope and entry point
Inertial relative position	Supported	Three components; RelativePosition
Both body-attitude covariance tangents	Supported	Three local directions per body; BodyAttitude
Primary barycentric position	Supported	Direct mass-ratio partial plus propagated dependence; PrimaryBarycentricPosition
Polynomial observation bias	Supported	Explicit SI offset/rate/higher polynomial terms; PolynomialBias
Uniform positive elapsed epochs	Supported	First observation after one cadence; no invented off-grid final sample
Blackouts, passes, windows/duty cycles	Supported	Masks on the base uniform grid; PeriodicBlackout, Periodic, Windows
Per-stream schedules/cadence masks	Supported	Scheduled, Every, schedule composition with `&`, `|`, `~`
Custom analytic observation channels	Supported extension point	Conform to the observation contract, with explicit value/derivative availability and tests
Arbitrary custom-observable AD	Planned	Default AD differentiates the maintained dynamics; it does not automatically differentiate every user channel
Irregular off-grid observations	Planned	Schedule masks select available grid epochs
State-dependent visibility	Planned	Occultation, field of view and phase-angle geometry are not provided
Real Hera data ingestion/range/Doppler adapters	Planned	Current built-ins represent idealized formal measurement information
General observed-attitude residual adapter	Planned	Built-in attitude tangents do not imply a full measured-attitude fit

See observations and schedule/multi-arc evidence.

Statistics and covariance

Feature	Status	Scope and entry point
Independent measurement noise	Supported	DiagonalNoise
Full correlated measurement noise	Supported	Exact scalar row order and mixed physical units matter; CorrelatedNoise
Correlated Gaussian priors	Supported	Named coordinates, explicit units/reference/mean; GaussianPrior
Mapped prior rows	Supported	PriorBlock; independent composition with provenance

Feature	Status	Scope and entry point
Kaula prior from shape ensembles	Supported	Separate fit/apply degrees, zonal/nonzonal laws, optional raw-moment rows; KaulaRule, KaulaPrior
Scaled joint QR/SVD covariance	Supported	Rank/null support recorded; SquareRootSolver
Local nuisance projection	Supported	Householder elimination, marginal physical support and local condition guard; NuisanceProjectedSolver
Full joint/cross covariance	Supported where numerically supported	Preserved for physical report transforms and local/shared blocks
Rank-deficient problems	Supported diagnostics	Null-sensitive uncertainty is unavailable; a pseudoinverse is not finite knowledge in null directions
Stable analysis identities	Supported	Scientific configuration/scales retained; wall-clock timing excluded from identity
Reweight saved rows	Supported	Noise/prior changes without new propagation; provider/model compatibility is checked
Batch consider covariance	Supported	External correlated PSD uncertainty; complete estimated/consider cross terms, direct outputs and estimated-space ranks; guide
Source-factor output maps	Supported	Retained QR/SVD factors avoid dense covariance cancellation; `derived_stable()` and history helpers
Formal covariance bias/truncation-error prediction	Planned	A force-order comparison conditions each covariance on its own model; it is not a bias estimate

See statistics and workflow. Priors can improve posterior support; they must not be described as improving the measurement-only information.

Independent arcs and actual estimation

Feature	Status	Scope and entry point
High-level independent-arc covariance	Supported	Shared masses/field, separate local state and channel nuisance per arc; MultiArcCovarianceStudy
Composition of frozen arc linearizations	Supported	Label/unit/physical-definition checks, shared prior once, cross-arc whitening; MultiArcStudy
Linearized residual correction	Supported	Weighted local least-squares correction and nullspace-aware covariance; `MultiArcStudy.estimate`
Callback-based nonlinear batch/MAP driver	Partial pipeline	Implemented objective/backtracking/relinearization framework with independent recovery checks; MultiArcBatchEstimator
Ready-to-use real binary observation fit	Planned	Requires validated measured-value/residual adapters and physical context refresh/retraction callbacks

Feature	Status	Scope and entry point
Sequential filters/smoothers	Planned	No EKF, UKF, information filter or smoother is delivered
Process noise/dynamical continuity constraints	Planned	Existing arcs are independent; no hidden process noise or continuity penalty
Partial state resets/shared channel biases	Planned	High-level arc state and nuisance coordinates are local; inspect lower-level composition before custom use
Global binary state with per-arc spacecraft state	Planned	Different from the current independent binary-state formulation

The generic nonlinear driver is implemented; a complete Hera observation-data fitting application is not. Multi-arc documentation explains the independent-arc assumption and RK4/SO(3) restart sensitivity on chaotic trajectories.

Results, plots and reproducibility

Feature	Status	Scope and entry point
Atomic numeric artifacts	Supported	JSON/NPY, hashes, no-overwrite completion; write_artifact, read_artifact
Standard study export/reload	Supported	Descriptive run folders, tables, arrays, units and checksum verification; export_study, read_run
Shared presentation model	Supported	Numerical tables feed all formats; make_presentation
PNG/SVG/PDF and table formats	Supported	Common paper palette, grids/fonts, CSV/Markdown/LaTeX, optional external TeX; PlotTheme
User plot definitions	Supported	Replaceable figure builder consumes the shared result dataset; PlotDefinition
Hera Table 2	Supported reproduction	Four fresh default-AD cases; all 36 printed entries and all 160 report sigmas pass
Hera Figure 3	Supported reproduction	Archived cloud refits, with fresh seeded demonstration as a separate mode
Hera Figure 5	Supported reproduction	Exact degree/basis/prior cases, reused completed BASCO transports
All original R21 studies	Partial	Six same-dynamics variants checked; 13 remain unverified
Covariance histories	Supported selected batch scope	Exact observation prefixes and fixed-information ideal-output propagation; guide and Hera plots
CubeSat landing footprint	Planned	Restricted dynamics, near-surface field, release and contact-event sensitivities need implementation; roadmap

See results, Hera, and the example gallery.

Derivative and platform evidence

Feature	Status	Scope
Hou AD transport	Supported, default	Optional JAX CPU float64 backend; lazy imports; no silent native fallback
Hou native analytic transport	Supported, explicit	Preserved hand-derived math/native implementation
Native-versus-AD acceptance	Supported	Same-problem tests, snapshots and Hera comparisons
Opt-in finite-difference checks	Supported selected coverage	Native RHS, parameter map, attitude retraction, high-degree/report/barycentric checks and AD/legacy checks
Complete end-to-end covariance FD	Partial	Complete transport, covariance-propagation and prior coverage remains incomplete
Bitwise refactor snapshots	Supported on recorded host	Native 87/87 and AD 117/117 equal the Mac Phase 1 baselines after Phase 2
Managed locked macOS arm64 runtime	Validated	CPython 3.13.16; native development dependencies and current macOS deployment constraints apply
Linux portability	Partial evidence	Earlier cloud validation exists; it is not a universal release/portability certificate
Windows/release wheels for all systems	Planned/unvalidated	No supported portable-binary promise today

The Phase 2 record contains exact installed-source/runtime identities, ordinary suite outcomes and opt-in validation results. Ordinary covariance execution does not launch finite-difference probes. Derivative methods shows how to request checks deliberately.

Where future work is tracked

The authoritative scope is requirements. Implementation status distinguishes complete increments from remaining work; decisions record selected scientific/API policy. Phase 2 is complete; later modularity phases and wider real estimation/filtering scope are separate work.

Troubleshooting

When something fails, identify the boundary first: environment/build, physical inputs, propagation identity, observation layout, statistical support or presentation. Fixing one boundary by quietly changing another can produce plausible but scientifically different results.

Environment and build problems

Symptom	Check and action
Source changes appear ignored	The runner uses the installed wheel. Rebuild with `python3 -B tools/dev.py build` after library edits.
JAX dependency error	Plain studies default to AD. Prepare `ad_environment` or install the AD extra; for native-only work explicitly select `NativeAnalyticTransport()` and `run --native`.
Matplotlib unavailable	Prepare `plot_environment` and run with `--plot`; numeric exports do not need plotting.
CMake/compiler/Armadillo/OpenBLAS failure	Check the host compiler and native development dependencies. Do not repair global Python packages or install into read-only original projects.
Relative input file not found	The managed runner starts outside the checkout. Resolve script-owned paths from `Path(__file__)` or pass absolute paths.
Different machine fails	macOS arm64 is the currently validated deployment. Portability/build acceptance on other targets remains separate work.

The host Python launches the helper; the managed interpreter executes science; the wheel/native libraries provide the installed implementation. Record all three identities when diagnosing a build or run. Do not reinstall a shared runtime role while another scientific process is using it.

Physical input errors

Error or suspicious behavior	Meaning
Missing moments	Nominal table completeness does not satisfy the chosen order. Supply them, or explicitly declare scientifically justified zeros.

Error or suspicious behavior	Meaning
Center/principal-axis rejection	First moments or products of inertia violate the supported representation. Align the geometry/moments correctly.
Unexpected scales/masses	Verify semi-axes versus diameters, density units, mass-weighted versus geometric moments and OBJ length conversion.
Invalid rotation	Supply proper mapping-direction rotations; do not silently project arbitrary invalid inputs.
Unexpected relative motion	Public velocity is inertial relative velocity expressed in primary components, not the rotating-frame derivative. Secondary spin is also expressed in primary components.

See units and frames and shape ingestion. High-degree models are especially sensitive to incomplete nominal data and incompatible normalization.

Grid and schedule errors

Cadence must be positive, duration must include at least one cadence, and the output grid must align with fixed RK4 steps. Multi-arc lengths must also align with the cadence/grid. Uniform plans start one cadence after the arc origin.

Schedules select existing epochs only. A pass window narrower than the grid can select no observations; that is a plan issue, not a reason to invent an epoch. `schedule_offset` determines mission-time phase, and `Windows` uses half-open intervals. Inspect `plan.visibility()` and `plan.schedule_description()` before propagation.

Transport reuse rejected

A retained trajectory's shape alone is not enough to establish compatibility. Physics, nominal state, parameter map/raw slots, epochs, derivative provider and integration policy enter its checked identity.

If a study was native, construct its reuse target with explicit native transport too; an AD default must not relabel native evidence. Changing gravity order or integration step requires new matching propagation. For supported statistical/channel changes, follow reuse and trades instead of editing identity fields.

Missing or surprising uncertainty

An unresolved direction is a result, not necessarily a software failure. Check:

1. Whether the duration, geometry and channel selection can identify the chosen quantities.
2. Whether initial state and barycenter nuisance are coestimated or fixed.
3. Whether raw higher-degree trace directions require explicitly stated prior knowledge.
4. Data rank versus posterior/marginal rank, coordinate scales, singular spectrum and solver policy.

5. Integration-step refinement and basis/threshold sensitivity where conditioning matters.

An unavailable full covariance cannot be replaced by arbitrary diagonals of a supported-subspace matrix. Zero nominal coefficients have no percentage uncertainty. A fixed coefficient's zero sigma means conditioned, not measured perfectly.

The projected solver's nuisance-condition error identifies a local block it cannot safely eliminate. Do not loosen its guard merely to obtain finite numbers. Reassess arc length/geometry, parameterization and the intended support policy, and preserve the rejected configuration as part of the analysis record.

Prior problems

Labels and units must match the coordinate layout. Priors with correlated quantities must retain their covariance. Shared multi-arc knowledge is supplied once globally; arc-local copies touching shared parameters are rejected.

A Kaula radius/normalization mismatch must be resolved at the physical mapping boundary, not by changing its label. For iterative fitting, maintain fixed observations, noise and prior means while rebuilding current references. Noise and priors explains the distinction.

Plotting and export problems

`tex=True` needs external LaTeX. Use `tex=False` for built-in math text when a TeX toolchain is unavailable. The plotting environment must be installed even when the covariance calculation itself succeeded.

Writers refuse an existing destination. Choose a fresh run folder instead of overwriting evidence. A failed checksum or incomplete-artifact error means the folder is not verified evidence; preserve it for diagnosis rather than bypassing verification.

`read_run` reloads arrays/reports/metadata, not a live study object. Restyling reports launches no propagation. Reanalyzing saved rows requires a correctly reconstructed scientific/layout context rather than merely loading an NPY matrix.

Minimal reproducibility record

For each saved result, retain the repository commit and installed wheel/source identity; input hashes and provenance; body/state units and frames; G and reference radii; nominal gravity order and estimated parameter basis/body selection; epochs/cadence/gaps; derivative provider and integration step; noise/prior definitions; solver/scales/rank settings; and complete output manifests/status.

Standard exports capture much of this automatically. Add external input sources and scientific rationale through provenance. Distinguish fresh propagation, captured archive replay, reanalysis of retained transport and pure restyling.

Checking run completion

Do not infer completion from a directory existing or a process having started. A complete manifest, matching checksums and explicit command status are needed. Keep incomplete artifacts separate. Never overwrite frozen reference inputs or baselines when a new implementation gives a different answer.

The current project state, requirements and validation records distinguish implemented capabilities from future plans. Full binary-data fitting, custom-observable AD, end-to-end FD, sequential filtering and broad portability remain open; this manual does not promote them to finished features.

Public API index

Signatures, methods and attributes are documented in the API reference.

Import	Kind	Description
`G_SI`	constant	Default fixed gravitational constant, 6.674e-11 $m^3\ kg^{-1}\ s^{-2}$. Mass estimates assume this selected G is exact; pass a different fixed G to BinarySystem explicitly.
`RK4`	class	Fixed integration step in seconds, positive and finite. Both maintained Hou routes use the retained RK4 policy; this object does not select the derivative method.
`AllOf`	class	Keep epochs accepted by every component schedule (&).
`Always`	class	A schedule that retains every supplied grid epoch.
`AnyOf`	class	Keep epochs accepted by at least one component schedule (|).
`Arc`	class	One named interval of mission elapsed seconds, [start, stop].
`ArcTimeline`	class	Contiguous independent estimation arcs on one global elapsed-time timeline. A boundary observation belongs to the arc ending at that epoch. Arc boundaries must be compatible with the common grid.
`BarLayout`	class	Configure grouped-bar geometry independently of the result data. Dimensions are inches. group_by='parameter' puts quantities on the horizontal axis and cases in the legend; 'case' exchanges those roles. Colors and optional hatches follow legend order.
`BinaryDynamics`	class	Owns nominal binary physics independently of observations, derivative provider, priors and covariance solver. Change gravity order by constructing a new model; transport reuse will reject an incompatible identity.
`BinaryState`	class	Position and inertial velocity are relative-secondary-to-primary vectors expressed in primary-body components. Velocity is not d(position_in_primary_frame)/dt. Both inertial spin vectors are also expressed in primary components. A_to_N maps primary components to inertial components; B_to_A maps secondary components to primary components. Public lengths are metres, rates radians/s, and rotation matrices dimensionless.
`BinarySystem`	class	Collect the two bodies, one initial state, fixed G and a readable system name. Initial enclosing bounding spheres must not intersect.
`Body`	class	A named UniformEllipsoid or MomentDistribution. Its mass is the raw degree-zero moment; inertia returns the three principal moments of inertia in $kg\ m^2$.

Import	Kind	Description
`BodyAttitude`	class	Local three-component attitude prediction errors for the selected body. sigma is in radians, not degrees; use numpy.deg2rad for degree-valued uncertainty.
`CoefficientEnsemble`	class	Nominal/shape/interior gravitational coefficients with body, reference radius, normalization and provenance. Ensemble coefficients are dimensionless geodesy 4π-normalized; they are not the ordinary unnormalized harmonic report.
`ConsiderParameters`	class	An external, possibly correlated PSD uncertainty on named coordinates.
`ConsiderResult`	class	Conditional estimated-space information and full-source error covariance.
`CoordinateLayout`	class	Named column ordering, physical units and positive numerical scales. n_state marks the leading arc-local state/nuisance block; remaining columns are shared physical parameters. Scales do not contribute prior information.
`CorrelatedNoise`	class	A positive-definite full residual covariance, in the exact row order and mixed row units of the linearization. Cholesky whitening retains correlations. Large dense matrices may be expensive.
`CovarianceHistory`	class	Accumulated-data batch results for one fixed reference-epoch layout.
`CovarianceResult`	class	Covariance and support diagnostics tied to an explicit named layout. A deficient supported-subspace covariance is not a full covariance. Unsupported derived uncertainty is unavailable, not zero.
`CovarianceSolver`	class	Analyze whitened SI rows and return a CovarianceResult.
`CovarianceStudy`	class	Configure the nominal dynamics, estimated parameters, observations, integration, derivative method, noise, priors and covariance solver. Hou AD is selected when transport is omitted. Missing JAX raises an error that identifies the required dependency; there is no automatic native fallback.
`DensityVariation`	class	Mass-preserving core/shell/torus interior alternatives for coefficient ensembles. Verify that chosen regions lie inside your body; the generic mesh does not prove that containment.
`DerivedCovarianceHistory`	class	Mapped uncertainty with an explicit time-axis meaning in ``metadata``.
`DerivedReport`	class	A derived table retains labels, nominal values, units, transformation Jacobian, covariance availability and conventions. sigma is an absolute one-sigma quantity; percentages at a zero nominal coefficient are undefined.
`DiagonalNoise`	class	Positive independent residual standard deviations in each named row unit. Supplies whitening, not extra dynamics.
`DifferentiableGravityModel`	class	Optional extension capability for a JAX-traceable SI potential(r, C_AB, T_A, T_B, G). Native analytic support is not implied by supplying an AD-compatible potential.
`Every`	class	Retain epochs separated by period seconds relative to offset, when they lie on the supplied base grid. It does not interpolate or create off-grid measurements.

Import	Kind	Description
`GaussianPrior`	class	Named Gaussian knowledge on explicit coordinate labels/units and covariance. mean=None uses the producer reference convention; for iterative fitting preserve a fixed intended mean rather than recentering it at every iteration.
`GravityModel`	class	Runtime-checkable minimal gravity declaration with mutual_order. Member-presence checks do not establish backend compatibility or physical correctness; maintained Hou evaluators own the Hou equations.
`HouGravity`	class	The maintained binary gravity workflow uses total mutual expansion order 2, 4 or 6. This nominal order is separate from the estimated moment/harmonic degrees, which currently run through degree 4.
`IndependentPriors`	class	Compose independent prior producers while preserving each block metadata and its internal correlations. Independence between blocks is an assumption, not inferred from their names.
`IntegrationSchedule`	class	Provider-level propagation/output policy, independent of observation weights and priors. Epochs are increasing positive elapsed seconds; transports also retain the epoch-zero initial state.
`KaulaPrior`	class	Map the rule normalization/radius through the physical-coordinate Jacobian. raw_moment_priors=True additionally selects the paper's independent RMS-touching raw-moment constraints; it is separate from harmonic knowledge and adds no implicit mass/state/barycenter prior.
`KaulaRule`	class	Fitted zonal/nonzonal normalized-coefficient magnitude laws and adopted sigmas. Persist with to_dict/from_dict. A law describes an explicit empirical prior assumption rather than an observed covariance result.
`LeastSquaresSolver`	class	Optional correction on the same numerical support as its covariance.
`LinearizedStudy`	class	Owned, frozen prediction rows with named row/column layouts, nominal, transport, noise/prior context and content identity. Reanalysis changes statistical assumptions without rerunning dynamics.
`MasconSet`	class	Point masses fixed in a body frame: positions in metres, masses in kilograms.
`MomentDistribution`	class	Explicit centered principal-axis mass moments in SI. The reference radius fixes harmonic normalization; the bounding radius supports non-overlap checks; characteristic_length sets numerical coordinate scales. Missing moments are errors unless missing="zero" is deliberately selected.
`MultiArcBatchEstimator`	class	Generic callback-based nonlinear batch/MAP loop with relinearization and objective backtracking. Callers supply correctly signed residuals and physical retractions. Mission-style binary observed-value adapters, recovery validation and multiple filters remain future work.
`MultiArcBatchResult`	class	Returned state, study, covariance, status and iteration history from the generic batch loop. Inspect explicit convergence status; a returned result does not automatically imply convergence.
`MultiArcCovarianceStudy`	class	High-level binary multi-arc covariance: one continuous nominal, independent local initial-state errors per arc, shared masses/gravity, and optional arc-local nuisance. Shared priors enter once. There is no implicit continuity constraint.

Import	Kind	Description
`MultiArcEstimate`	class	A single weighted linearized correction, with null-aware covariance.
`MultiArcStudy`	class	Assemble arbitrary already-linearized arcs into named local columns plus shared physical columns. Default measurement noise is independent across arcs; a full joint whitening model can express cross-arc correlation.
`NativeAnalyticTransport`	class	Explicit preserved Hou values plus hand-derived partials. Supports the centered principal-axis order-2/4/6 Hou workflow and fixed RK4. This route does not require JAX.
`NoiseModel`	class	Whiten a vector or row matrix without changing its shape or ordering.
`Not`	class	Invert a component schedule (~).
`NuisanceProjectedSolver`	class	Alternative Householder elimination of local nuisance directions with marginal physical support diagnostics. Inspect joint versus marginal rank; its support criteria need not produce identical availability decisions to joint scaling.
`ObservationChannel`	class	Prediction-direction contract: named labels/units, positive noise sigma, and signed local native-state/direct-parameter partials. Actual fixed-data residuals for nonlinear fitting are a separate contract.
`ObservationPlan`	class	Owns one regular base grid and channel definitions. Schedules remove selected observation rows on this grid; they do not skip propagation stages. Arbitrary off-grid observation epochs are not implemented by the fixed-step transport.
`ObservationSchedule`	class	Select epochs on the plan's uniform grid without changing dynamics.
`Parameters`	class	Select independent estimated parameters for one nominal model: masses, moments or higher-degree exterior harmonics, and optionally the 18 physical initial-state errors. Selection order determines column order.
`Periodic`	class	A periodic keep-window schedule on the existing epoch grid. period, duration and phase are in elapsed seconds.
`PeriodicBlackout`	class	Remove a repeated blackout duration within a period, in seconds. Combine masks with &, | and ~; consult the source for boundary conventions.
`PlotDefinition`	class	A named figure-drawing function and caption. The function receives presentation data and a plot theme, and returns a figure or None without recomputing covariance.
`PlotTheme`	class	Shared palette, typography, optional grids and output formats. Defaults follow the Hera plotting source: 9.5-point STIX typography, 300 dpi and no grid. tex=False uses Matplotlib mathtext; tex=True requires an external LaTeX installation.
`PolynomialBias`	class	Observation-only polynomial coordinates with explicit units/reference epoch. Degree 1 and three components add barycenter position and rate; no prior is introduced implicitly. These are nuisance parameters, not a change to nominal binary gravity.

Import	Kind	Description
`PrimaryBarycentricPosition`	class	Predict the primary position relative to system center of mass: -M_B/(M_A+M_B) times inertial relative separation, plus optional bias. Includes direct mass-ratio derivatives as well as transported dynamical effects. sigma is in metres.
`PriorBlock`	class	Advanced mapped prior rows with explicit layout, mean/reference and noise. Supports a prior on a derived linear combination without pretending it is a coordinate-wise independent constraint.
`PriorProvider`	class	Produce a concrete basco.PriorBlock, without selecting a solver.
`RadialShapeSampler`	class	Seeded radial shape perturbations with requested RMS roughness and correlation lengths in metres. Choose sample count, resolution, frame/realignment and legacy seed convention explicitly for a science campaign.
`RelativePosition`	class	Three relative-position prediction directions, with sigma in metres. Only frame="inertial" is currently implemented.
`ResolvedParameters`	class	The physical-coordinate map owns labels/units and derived physical reports, while numerical covariance solvers remain independent of binary physics. raw_jacobian includes mass-to-moment pathways, not just selected diagonal entries.
`Scheduled`	class	Wrap one existing channel to give it its own cadence, pass windows or blackouts on the common plan grid. The wrapper preserves the channel labels, units and native partial method.
`SquareRootSolver`	class	Default joint scaled solver using SVD for numerical support and QR for covariance/correction. Positive scales and rank_rtol control numerical representation/support; neither adds information.
`Transport`	class	Immutable epochs, native30 states, state transition, raw SI-moment sensitivities, physical-coordinate sensitivities, diagnostics and validity identity. Save labels/units and identity with numerical arrays; raw and physical sensitivity axes are different.
`TransportIdentity`	class	A canonical content identity over declared physical/numerical inputs and derivative-coordinate mappings. It prevents accidentally reusing a transport for changed gravity or solve-for derivatives; it is not proof of numerical accuracy.
`TransportProvider`	class	A replaceable provider owns physics propagation and variational transport; it must return the owned Transport with correct layouts, units and content identity. It does not choose observations, priors or covariance solver.
`TriangleMesh`	class	A closed, outward-wound triangular surface in metres with provenance. Topology/volume checks do not certify absence of every possible self-intersection or interior-region containment.
`UniformEllipsoid`	class	A homogeneous ellipsoid with positive semi-axes in metres and density in kg/m³. Supplies analytic mass-weighted moments through degree 6; estimating independent moments does not constrain the uncertain body to remain homogeneous.

Import	Kind	Description
`VariationalEvaluator`	class	Callable value-plus-derivative evaluation F, A=dF/dx and B=dF/dT used by the common variational integration owner. No specific force implementation is required by this structural protocol.
`Windows`	class	Keep epochs inside explicit elapsed-second intervals; Windows.around builds windows around listed pass centers.
`analyze_consider`	function	Partition full-source whitened rows into estimated and consider columns.
`analyze_design`	function	Analyze already-whitened named-layout rows directly. If you start from physical measurement partials, apply the correct noise whitening first; passing raw rows changes the statistical problem.
`build_shape_ensemble`	function	Generate coefficient statistics from shape and optional density members, independently of dynamical order. realign=True aligns each perturbed copy; False retains its perturbation-frame convention. These are scientifically different ensembles.
`covariance_history`	function	Exact batch covariance prefixes, without repropagating dynamics.
`export_covariance_history`	function	Write a mapped history, full output covariance and source Jacobians.
`export_study`	function	Write the standard descriptive run folder with configuration, named arrays, presentation, provenance and checksums. Its analysis identity excludes runtime timing while retaining science/statistical choices and scales.
`make_presentation`	function	Build the shared result dataset used by tables and plots. Supply rows to retain the linearization settings; custom derived reports can be added to the same presentation.
`observable_covariance`	function	Map a fixed result to ideal, noise-free observable error coordinates.
`physical_dual`	function	A checked left inverse of physical_lift. Transposing the lift alone does not provide its dual.
`physical_lift`	function	Map an 18-component SI/local-attitude error into native30 tangent space. Left attitude perturbations are used; the first six components include metre-to-kilometre conversion.
`propagate_covariance`	function	Map a FIXED result through explicit output Jacobians at physical epochs.
`read_artifact`	function	Verify schema, array shapes/dtypes and hashes before returning arrays/metadata. Untrusted paths and external symlink targets are rejected by shared readers.
`read_covariance_history`	function	Verify a complete history export and reconstruct its immutable record.
`read_presentation`	function	Verify and reload saved table and plot data without rerunning dynamics. It does not reconstruct a live study.
`read_run`	function	Verify and reload the standard run into arrays, presentation and run metadata. Numeric evidence is reloaded, not a live model/study.
`references`	module	basco.references

Import	Kind	Description
`retract_native`	function	Apply a finite physical SI/local-SO(3) error to a native30 state. This is an explicit estimation/retraction utility rather than a propagation-time correction.
`run_path`	function	Descriptive UTC name plus identity; never overwrite an existing run.
`schedules`	module	basco.schedules
`subset_noise`	function	Marginal residual noise for selected ORIGINAL scalar row identities.
`transport_identity`	function	Identify physical inputs, derivative coordinates and numerical policy.
`write_artifact`	function	Atomic JSON/NPY evidence container with hashes and shape/dtype declarations. Object arrays and pickle are excluded; preserve named unit/layout metadata explicitly.
`write_presentation`	function	Atomically write JSON, Markdown, CSV and LaTeX tables, plus optional PNG/SVG/PDF figures, from a presentation dataset. The destination must be new; existing completed results are not overwritten.
`write_run`	function	Atomic complete run: overview, config, reports, arrays and validation.